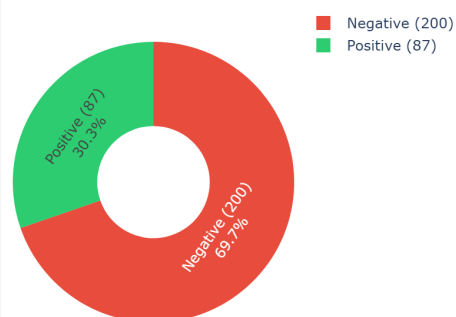


DAILY MEDIA ENERGY MONITOR

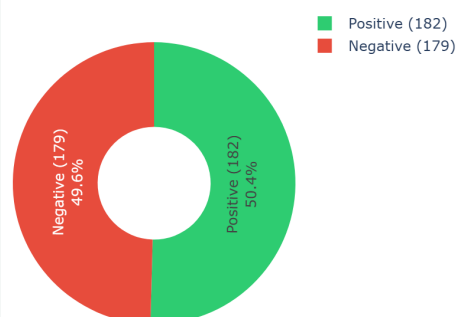
01 Jun - 10 June 2026

 BUSINESS RECORDER Founded by M.A. Zuberi	 THE EXPRESS TRIBUNE WITH THE International New York Times	 DAWN FOUNDED BY QUAID-I-AZAM MUHAMMAD ALI JINNAH	 propakistani	 The Guardian	 INTERNATIONAL THE NEWS PAKISTAN
152	67	33	20	10	5
					
344	9	8			

Consolidated News Sentiment



Consolidated Social Sentiment



Executive Summaries

10 June 2026:

Pakistan's energy and fiscal system faces systemic collapse under chronic inefficiency, corruption, and policy inertia, exacerbated by soaring debt, inflation, and climate crises. Despite IMF pressures and renewed CPEC alignment, the government's 2026–27 budget prioritizes renewables and infrastructure amid austerity, yet lacks significant investment. Judicial restraint shields energy tariffs, while provincial budgets are squeezed, sparking constitutional tensions. Privatization of DISCOs, EV policies, and SME support are key reforms, yet political deadlock, rising oil prices, and weak fiscal coordination undermine progress. Climate risks and digital divides demand urgent, human-centered reforms—beyond optics—to stabilize the economy, restore public trust, and unlock industrial potential.

09 June 2026:

Pakistan's FY2026–27 budget faces escalating energy inflation, subsidy cuts, and grid integration hurdles, risking economic strain and energy poverty. While austerity yields savings, urgent reforms—renewables, grid modernization, and strategic reserves—are vital to restore competitiveness and energy security. Stalled federal negotiations and provincial resistance delay progress, amid business calls for tax reforms and export diversification. Global energy volatility, including Red Sea disruptions, adds pressure. Domestic savings have plummeted, prompting financial inclusion and fiscal restraint measures. The EV policy and digital infrastructure gaps highlight emerging challenges, while U.S.-led diplomacy offers temporary relief amid persistent geopolitical risks. Coordinated, transparent governance is critical to navigate global volatility and domestic reform.

08 June 2026:

Pakistan's energy and economic crisis deepens amid global shocks and domestic policy failures, with renewables insufficiently scaled and infrastructure crumbling. Structural inefficiencies, debt-driven tariffs, and weak governance hinder reform, despite 2026–27 budget promises. Fiscal weakness, low tax-to-GDP, and circular debt exacerbate instability, while youth unemployment and AI-driven job displacement demand skills-based education. Critical projects like Chinot Dam and Reko Diq offer resilience, yet require urgent constitutional reform and independent fiscal oversight. Climate extremes, safety failures, and geopolitical tensions further strain systems. Without structural separation of DISCOs, transparent pricing, and adaptive infrastructure, Pakistan risks deeper social and economic collapse—its survival hinges on inclusive, urgent, and systemic transformation.

07 June 2026:

Pakistan's economy strains under IMF austerity, SOE losses, and stalled reforms, while critical energy infrastructure remains underfunded, threatening

security and climate resilience. Political gridlock, budget delays, and multilateral reliance complicate execution, as civil society and business warn of job losses and investor flight amid proposed EPZ and tariff shifts. Rising cyber threats and political demands for tax relief and autonomy further destabilize policy. Despite Saudi-backed investment initiatives, the neoliberal trajectory risks deepening fragility. Calls for supply-side reforms, targeted support, and balanced fiscal discipline offer a path to stability amid persistent inflation, poverty, and unemployment.

06 June 2026:

Pakistan is accelerating its digital and energy transition amid economic fragility, with major investments in AI infrastructure, renewables, and grid modernization, yet faces persistent inflation, geopolitical volatility, and institutional weaknesses. Despite ambitious targets—USD100B exports, 50% emissions cut by 2035, and 4.0% GDP growth—progress is hampered by corruption, weak governance, and stalled reforms. Strategic partnerships with Gulf and multilateral lenders, alongside CPEC 2.0's push for productivity, offer hope, but require urgent tax reforms, export incentives, and institutional overhaul to unlock private sector revival and sustainable energy transformation.

05 June 2026:

Pakistan's energy and economic resilience is under severe strain from fiscal mismanagement, policy fragmentation, and climate vulnerability. While renewables gain global traction, domestic policy sidelines green tech, taxes clean energy, and neglects adaptation despite global pressure. Institutional fractures, power theft, and delayed hydropower projects like Dasu exacerbate supply shortages. NEPRA's tariff adjustments aim to offset fuel costs, yet broader reforms—tax cuts, export incentives, and non-neoliberal governance—are urgently needed. Climate risks, including 2022 floods and El Niño-driven droughts, threaten agriculture and GDP, with experts warning of catastrophic losses by 2050 if action is delayed. Global supply chain shifts and IMF demands

for fiscal discipline further intensify pressure, demanding coordinated, climate-proofed, and investor-friendly reforms.

04 June 2026:

Pakistan's energy and fiscal systems are under acute pressure from global LNG price spikes, monsoon floods, war-induced remittance losses, and El Niño volatility, straining power supply and economic recovery. While LNG imports from Qatar and tariff reforms aim to stabilize supply, renewables remain underdeveloped and politically reversed. Austerity measures are being eased temporarily, but budget delays, IMF pressure, and coalition tensions threaten stability. Political opposition demands pipeline revival and tariff cuts, while privatization faces legal and financial hurdles. AI's rising energy demand and legal opacity around IMF debt further complicate the landscape. Systemic failures, corruption, and policy inaction risk turning temporary stability into prolonged stagnation.

03 June 2026:

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget, shaped by Shehbaz Sharif and business elites, seeks export-led growth, renewables, and tariff cuts, yet risks deepening inequality and economic stagnation amid structural weaknesses, grid constraints, and delayed approvals. Fuel and utility taxes burden low-income households, while elite and informal sectors benefit. The auto sector thrives on SUVs and EVs, but geopolitical risks and supply chain fragility loom. Power sector governance is under scrutiny, with LNG disruptions and renewables sidelined. Global AI and crypto trends offer hope, yet domestic policy instability, IMF negotiations, and rising inflation (8.2%) threaten progress. Fiscal deficit narrowed but tax collection lags, and provincial spending surges without alignment, underscoring urgent need for policy coherence, investor confidence, and energy resilience.

02 June 2026:

Pakistan's energy and economic reforms face mounting pressure as fiscal austerity clashes with growth ambitions. Power sector modernization, subsidy cuts, and crypto taxation aim to curb debt and inflation, yet execution delays and investor uncertainty persist. While renewables, AI, and digitalization offer growth levers, sectoral disparities and ethical concerns limit their impact. The government balances fiscal constraints—only Rs1.13tr for PSDP amid Rs4.097tr demands—with export incentives and SME support, despite inflation at 11.7% and rising energy costs. Privatisation, tax relief, and infrastructure prioritization signal a push for resilience, but success hinges on speed, clarity, and global investment alignment amid volatile markets and regional disparities.

01 June 2026:

Pakistan's equity market rallied 4%, fueled by geopolitical easing, LNG imports, and sectoral gains, though driven by domestic buying and state-linked capital. Energy reforms, including renewables now at 57% of the mix and streamlined solar licensing, aim to cut losses and subsidy burdens, yet shortages and protests persist. Fiscal uncertainty, inflation, and rising oil prices threaten growth, while AI costs surge and Gulf instability risks remittances. Despite ambitious clean energy targets and infrastructure investments, delayed disbursements and fiscal constraints risk economic slowdown, urging diversification, diplomacy, and skills development to attract FDI amid global uncertainty.

Key Energy Topics

Net Metering

Trade deficit surge

Pakistan's FY26 trade deficit widened amid energy reliance on imports, threatening economic stability. Renewables investment is urged as a long-term solution to reduce foreign exchange dependence, alongside diversifying exports beyond textiles and boosting high-value sectors. Energy security and import substitution are critical for fiscal resilience....

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Tribune

Negative

Is debt servicing manageable? - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces escalating debt servicing costs (up to 10% interest rate), rising public debt, and fiscal stagnation, undermining public spending on health, education, and infrastructure. Despite constitutional provisions, provincial budgets are squeezed by inflation and fixed costs. The IMF and UNCTAD warn of deepening debt distress, with no clear policy fix—highlighting systemic structural challenges over short-term tweaks....

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Business Recorder

Negative

More than half of clean energy schemes needed for Labour's 2030 target offered grid connection

...

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The Guardian

Positive

Solarization

Industrial modernization: PM tells ministries to talk to subject-matter experts - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif prioritizes industrial modernization, renewables, and EV policy to boost exports and energy security. He urges sectoral reforms, FDI attraction, and public welfare-driven planning, with renewables central to long-term energy strategy and economic resilience....

[Read More →](#)

Business Recorder

Positive

Infrastructure planning & implementation: TI-P flags corruption risks, governance gaps - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's infrastructure governance faces high corruption risk (6.34/10) due to weak implementation despite strong frameworks. Fiscal constraints, election-driven spending, and procurement loopholes hinder delivery. While reforms like iPAS and climate integration are steps forward, structural gaps between policy and practice remain the core challenge....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Privatisation

For the love of IMF

Pakistan's budget faces IMF-imposed fiscal constraints amid persistent SOE losses (Rs833B) and political inertia. Despite austerity promises, reforms stall as elites prioritize perks over efficiency. The IMF's oversight, while restrictive, prevents even worse fiscal mismanagement—a grim but necessary check on reckless spending....

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Tribune

Negative

PM directs to accelerate privatisation process of power DISCOs

PM Shehbaz Sharif prioritizes privatisation of three loss-making DISCOs (IESCO, GEPCO, FESCO) in Phase 1, urging transparency, investor roadshows (incl. Saudi, Türkiye, China), and robust regulation. Cabinet approves transaction structures; process to be expedited with international engagement....

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Tribune

Positive

PM Shehbaz orders swift Discos privatisation

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif prioritizes privatisation of three loss-making DISCOs, launching investor roadshows with global participation. He also reaffirmed commitments to global health partnerships, including the Global Fund, to eradicate TB, HIV, and malaria through joint working groups....

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Tribune

Positive

Billions set aside for tribal grid

Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa allocates Rs300M to upgrade electricity infrastructure in tribal districts, aiming to boost employment and development. Despite security concerns, TESCO reports improved bill collections and receives provincial support for power sector projects....

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Tribune

Positive

WAPDA informs Senate body: DHPP to become largest hydropower project - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 5,400MW Dasu Hydropower Project, funded with external loans, faces delays and scrutiny over progress and financial irregularities, including alleged fake invoice tax payments in solar projects. Senate committees call for accountability, tighter oversight, and faster execution to meet 2028 completion targets amid rising interest payments and stalled progress....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Solar Power Project in KP Remains Incomplete Despite 2019 Launch

A solar project in Khar Bazaar, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, remains non-operational due to funding shortfalls, drainage issues, and route resistance, despite near-completion. Local traders protest delays, urging action. PEDO plans to transfer management after two years, but unresolved technical and administrative hurdles persist....

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ProPakistani

Negative

IMF programme limits tax relief

Pakistan's government, under IMF pressure, is weighing tax relief for salaried and industrial classes, potentially abolishing dividend tax and reducing mobile phone duties. Petrol prices remain stagnant despite global drops. Renewables and EVs face tax hikes, while corporate taxes may stay unchanged. Fiscal space limits major reforms, with IMF approval pending....

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Tribune

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Technical education Pakistan's urgent employment path

Pakistan faces rising youth unemployment and AI-driven job displacement, making technical vocational training critical. Technical skills in energy, HVAC, and renewables offer immediate income, resilience against automation, and economic growth. University degrees, while valuable, often fail to translate into employment. The country must pivot toward skills-based education to meet industrial and energy sector demands....

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Tribune

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Govt urged to continue '80/20 facility' for industries in EPZs - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's business leaders warn against phasing out EPZs' 80/20 domestic sales rule by 2026, fearing economic damage, job losses, and investor flight. They stress EPZs' vital role in exports, foreign exchange, and FDI, urging government to preserve policy continuity amid IMF pressure, with proposals to retain facilities without disrupting existing investments....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Business leaders, PM in pre-budget consultations - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget prep sees PM Shehbaz Sharif promising tax relief, faster refunds, and export-driven growth. Key reforms include capped export refinance rates, PRAL relocation to Karachi, and EV production incentives. Business leaders urge faster delivery, while praising recent digitisation and privatisation efforts — though economic fragility and delays remain pressing concerns....

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Business Recorder

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Business leaders, PM Shehbaz in pre-budget consultations - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget faces pressure for faster reforms, tax relief, and export support. The government pledges to clear tax refunds, cap export refinance at 4.5%, and relocate PRAL to Karachi. Business leaders welcome digitisation and privatisation but demand speed and certainty, with EVs and housing initiatives highlighted as key growth areas....

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Business Recorder

Negative

The promise that keeps slipping away - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2025–2026 energy crisis is worsening amid global oil/LNG shocks, monsoon floods, and war-induced remittance losses. LNG imports plummeted, fueling industrial and agricultural collapse. GDP growth is down to 2.5–3.0%, austerity measures are escalating, and renewables' rise has been reversed by supply shocks. Energy insecurity threatens economic recovery....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

PTI accuses govt of manipulating GB polls - Pakistan - Business Recorder

PTI criticizes Pakistan's government for electoral interference in Gilgit-Baltistan and AJK, budgetary delays, and punitive energy policies targeting solar adoption. It accuses authorities of economic mismanagement, human rights violations, and political manipulation, calling for provincial autonomy, justice, and release of political prisoners....

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Pakistan savings hit three-decade low

Pakistan's savings rate has plummeted to 6.4%, driven by inflation and low returns, pushing reliance on foreign loans. PIDE urges budget reforms, digital savings access, and targeted incentives to boost domestic investment and reduce IMF dependency, warning of unsustainable debt growth....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Negative**

Budget: tax on hybrid cars may stay unchanged; up to 25pc sales tax on import of EVs likely - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government plans to impose 25% sales tax on imported EVs post-June 30, 2026, while extending customs duty exemptions for EV parts and locally assembled vehicles. The AIDEP 2021-26 policy supports green manufacturing, aligning with broader renewables and electric mobility goals....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Key committee lacks industry representation - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's energy policy review committee, led by Climate Change Minister Dr. Musadiq Malik, lacks industry representation, sparking criticism from auto sector stakeholders. Key energy-related policies, including solar manufacturing and storage, are under review, but the Engineering Development Board and industry groups feel excluded, raising concerns over policy relevance and stakeholder inclusiveness....

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Public procurement of electricity could save GB households £200 a year, says thinktank

...

[Read More →](#) The Guardian **Negative**

DISCOs, GENCOs: Senate body reviews sell-off plan progress - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's privatisation committee reviews DISCOs/GENCOs, with Quetta Electric facing financial hurdles. PIACL's Rs5bn payment, fleet expansion, and healthcare progress are under scrutiny. NCEL's Karachi property dispute with Pakistan Railways escalates, pending legal resolution. Renewables and power plants (Guddu, Nandipur) remain in deliberation....

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Dar chairs meeting on Discos' privatisation - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government accelerates Disco privatisation, targeting Batch-I (IESCO, FESCO, GEPCO) completion within timelines. Emphasis on regulatory oversight to ensure efficiency, transparency, and consumer protection. No direct renewables mention; focus remains on distribution reform and financial sustainability....

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Pakistan, KSA finalise series of investment deals - Business Recorder

Saudi Arabia and Pakistan finalized key investment agreements in infrastructure, energy, mining, and real estate, aiming to boost FDI and economic cooperation. Highlighting strategic projects like the Hyderabad-Karachi Motorway, the deals reflect Pakistan's push to stabilize its economy through Gulf partnerships and attract long-term investment....

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Govt Sets 4% GDP Growth Target for FY27

Pakistan targets 4% GDP growth for FY2026-27, driven by agriculture, manufacturing, and services, amid oil price volatility and geopolitical risks. The government pursues IMF-aligned reforms, boosts exports, and promotes renewables/digitalization to sustain recovery and attract private investment....

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Business community concerned federal budget - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's business leaders warn of economic stagnation under IMF pressure, urging a growth-focused fiscal policy over tax hikes. They call for tax reform, digitalization, and sectoral incentives to boost exports and FDI, while criticizing high energy costs and import duties as barriers to industrial revival....

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FPCCI rejects Punjab Infrastructure Development Cess - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Punjab industries oppose a new infrastructure cess, calling it double taxation amid high energy and regulatory costs. The levy risks boosting costs, discouraging investment, and harming exports and employment—potentially accelerating de-industrialization. No renewables or financial results mentioned....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Expensive AI binge leaves companies balking at soaring bills - World - DAWN.COM

AI costs are surging as enterprises shift from subsidized usage to cost-conscious strategies, opting for open-source or specialized models. Big players like OpenAI and Anthropic aim to go public, signaling a maturing market. While productivity gains remain uncertain, AI is becoming a commodity—driven by token efficiency, not just capability....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

Google owner Alphabet to sell \$80bn in stock to fund AI spending spree

Alphabet raises \$80bn to fund AI infrastructure, signaling AI's capital-intensive phase. Despite high spending, returns remain uncertain. Anthropic surges to \$965bn valuation, outpacing OpenAI. Tech giants race to IPOs, with Alphabet leading AI compute expansion amid growing investor scrutiny over ROI....

[Read More →](#) The Guardian **Positive**

Analysis: BUDGET 2026-27: Can Pakistan afford to delay its dams? - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's PSDP 2026-27 allocates only Rs179bn for hydropower, falling short of needed Rs500bn, risking delays on Diamer-Bhasha, Dasu, and Chenab dams. Despite 8 mega projects underway, funding constraints and India's upstream activities threaten energy security. Renewables and water infrastructure remain underfunded, raising concerns over climate resilience and economic growth....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

Big Discos: PM directs authorities to fast-track sell-off process - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif accelerates privatisation of key power distribution firms (IESCO, GEPCO, FESCO), aiming to reduce fiscal pressure, boost efficiency, and attract global investors via roadshows in Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and China, under a transparent regulatory framework to safeguard consumers....

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Licencing rules amended: Nepra introduces new category of 'on-site supplier' - Business Recorder

Nepra introduces new licensing rules enabling "on-site suppliers" to directly serve bulk consumers, while mandating generation licenses for all power providers. These reforms aim to boost market flexibility and reliability, with tariffs set by suppliers and exclusion from competitive markets. Consumers may still access backup power via last-resort or competitive suppliers....

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Global Crypto Giant Bitget Set to Enter Pakistan Market

Bitget, a global crypto platform, is entering Pakistan, seeking local talent for its CEO role. This coincides with Pakistan's potential crypto regulation in the upcoming budget, signaling a growing international interest in Pakistan's digital asset market amid rising crypto adoption and fintech innovation....

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Pakistan, China and the Middle East crisis

U.S.-Iran tensions escalate amid Trump's Middle East war, with China and Pakistan mediating. China supports ceasefire, vetoes UN military action, and seeks energy security via CPEC-2 linking Iran's Chabahar port to Gwadar. Iran's IRGC leans toward China, mirroring Pakistan's alignment, as regional powers vie for influence and resource access....

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Electricity laws: NA panel approves 2 amendments sans debate - Business Recorder

Pakistan's parliament approved key electricity law amendments to streamline governance, expedite B2B market launches, and reduce procedural delays. Changes replace "federal government" with "appropriate authorities," shorten notice periods, and clarify supply-distribution separation—supporting sector liberalization and renewables integration....

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Business
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Saudi Arabia plans crypto zone for Karachi

Pakistan and Saudi Arabia are collaborating to develop a maritime business district in Karachi, including a crypto/blockchain zone, digital banking, smart port tech, and education/healthcare facilities. The project aims to attract investment, boost employment, and position Pakistan as a regional maritime hub, with regulatory compliance ensured....

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Pakistan projected to post 21-year low budget deficit in outgoing FY26 - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's fiscal deficit shrinks to 3.6% of GDP in FY26, driven by SBP profits, higher petroleum levy, and debt retirement. Tight fiscal policy, IMF alignment, and political stability underpin the improvement. Tax collection lags, with June's target looming as a challenge. Renewables not mentioned....

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Business Recorder

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May OMC sales plunge 23pc YoY on higher fuel prices - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's OMCs saw steep fuel sales declines in May 2026 amid soaring prices (petrol +59%, diesel +57%), with PSO gaining market share. Furnace oil demand normalized. PDL collection hit 91% of FY2026 target. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on oil demand and fiscal revenue....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Surging demand: Pakistan secures three Qatari, one spot LNG cargoes - Business Recorder

Pakistan secured three LNG cargoes from Qatar and one spot shipment to meet summer power demand, while diverting subsidized indigenous gas. LNG imports are on CFR basis, with pricing reforms underway. Gas production restored post-conflict, aiding energy security amid rising demand....

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Three Qatari, one spot LNG cargoes secured - Business Recorder

Pakistan secured three LNG cargoes from Qatar and one spot cargo to meet summer power demand, while diverting subsidized indigenous gas. LNG imports are on CFR basis, with cost-recovery permits. Gas production restored post-conflict, and pricing reforms are underway. Renewables not mentioned....

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Business
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Pakistan Likely To Tax Cryptocurrency Transactions In Upcoming Budget

Pakistan plans to tax cryptocurrency gains under Budget 2026-27, imposing 20-30% CGT via amended Income Tax Ordinance. Focus is on regulating unregistered markets, defining crypto as financial instruments, and preventing capital flight—while balancing innovation and revenue. Taxation of mining, DeFi, NFTs, and ICOs also under review....

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Tariff Hikes

FCC entertains POL levy, tariff pleas

Pakistan's Federal Constitutional Court has accepted petitions challenging the petroleum levy and price hikes, urging an independent review. The government imposed the levy under IMF commitments, with rates at Rs117.41/litre for petrol and Rs42.60/litre for HSD. Legal scrutiny highlights fiscal and constitutional concerns amid ongoing energy policy debates....

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Fuel Price Adjustment

Solar Panels Become More Expensive Across Pakistan

Pakistan's solar panel prices surged sharply ahead of the federal budget, with costs rising Rs. 7,000–9,000 per panel. Market uncertainty over potential tax changes has driven up costs, raising concerns for consumers. Inverter prices may follow, impacting residential and commercial solar investments....

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Load Shedding

PESCO Approves One-Month Bonus for Employees

PESCO approves performance bonuses for eligible staff, excluding those linked to misconduct or delays. Govt reduces electricity charges temporarily. Infrastructure projects like Band Korai and Dera Ismail Khan stations advance, amid crackdown on underperforming officials and avoidance of unannounced load-shedding....

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ProPakistani

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S M Tanveer for export-led growth measures in budget - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's business leaders urge PM Shehbaz Sharif to boost exports via tax cuts and lower tariffs, criticizing inflation and debt burdens. Proposals include a 10% DLT rebate, electricity tariff reduction, and tax reform. Focus on renewables and industrial growth, with calls to simplify compliance and expand housing finance....

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Business Recorder

Positive

From crisis management to real reform - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's macroeconomic stability offers a window for reform, but true transformation hinges on tax, energy, debt, and SOE restructuring. Renewables and efficiency are critical for resilience. Without credible, sequenced reforms, stability risks becoming a temporary pause—not a turning point....

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Govt Plans New Tariff to Penalize Industries Using Less Grid Power and Moving to Solar

Pakistan's government proposes a "two-part industrial tariff" to curb grid exit by increasing fixed charges for low-usage industries, incentivizing higher consumption. The IMF is consulted; policy aims to recover fixed costs, boost demand, and stabilize the power sector amid rising solar and captive generation adoption. Implementation pending approval, with potential expansion to commercial/residential users....

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ProPakistani

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Middle East conflict and new global economic reset

Global energy markets are undergoing a geopolitical reset, driven by Ukraine-Russia and Middle East conflicts. Europe pivoted to LNG, raising costs; Asia and the U.S. compete for supplies. Pakistan, reliant on imports, faces inflation, trade deficits, and agricultural risks. Renewables and diversification are critical for resilience amid rising energy prices and fragmented global trade....

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Govt revises market timings, citing longer daylight hours, rising temperatures

Pakistan's federal government relaxed commercial closing times to 9pm (and 11pm for eateries) amid rising energy costs and global oil volatility. Austerity measures, initially imposed in April to curb fuel consumption, were eased as summer daylight extends. Exemptions cover essential services, EV charging, and healthcare. The move reflects ongoing efforts to balance energy conservation with economic and social needs....

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Budget FY27: Carrots fade - BR Research - Business Recorder

Government faces fiscal constraints, delaying promised relief despite rising oil prices. Petroleum levy revenue dominates, fueling high prices and inflation. GDP growth may slow, manufacturing suffers, and power subsidies for low-use consumers could end. Real estate and traders may benefit, while corporates and exporters face continued pressure. IMF pressures limit fiscal flexibility....

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Gas crisis deepens as supply disappears even during scheduled hours

Hyderabad faces severe gas shortages during peak summer, with Sui Southern Gas failing to deliver even scheduled supply, causing financial strain and hardship for households. Residents resort to alternatives like electric stoves and LPG cylinders, while political silence and unmet promises exacerbate the crisis....

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CAP expresses concern over Karachi water shortages - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Karachi faces recurring water supply disruptions due to Dhabeji Pumping Station failures, sparking outrage from CAP. Citizens suffer amid power cuts and heat, demanding urgent repairs and a high-level inquiry. K-Electric urged to act swiftly, with calls for permanent solutions to restore basic services....

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Business Recorder

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Scorching heatwave hits Karachi - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Karachi faces a severe heatwave exacerbated by power outages and inadequate infrastructure, worsening health risks, especially for vulnerable groups. Prolonged load-shedding and systemic failures intensify discomfort, prompting medical alerts and calls for urgent relief amid rising temperatures and public suffering....

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Business Recorder

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Leghari rejects reports of subsidy withdrawal for protected power consumers

Pakistan's Power Minister denies subsidy cuts, confirming continued support for 21.5M protected consumers amid tariff reductions. Reforms cut costs, boosted renewables to 57% of mix, aiming for 90% by 2035. Solar adoption encouraged via net billing, deregulation, and digitization. IMF conditions include phased subsidy withdrawal, but government insists subsidies remain intact....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Negative**

New power tariff to deter solar shift

Pakistan's government proposes a two-part industrial tariff to penalize low grid usage and incentivize higher consumption, aiming to boost industrial demand and recover fixed costs. The policy, under consultation with IMF, may extend to commercial/residential users, targeting energy-intensive sectors and potentially reshaping renewable adoption. IMF urges data transparency; policy could impact solar and captive generation decisions....

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Jl seeks end to costly IPP deals

Pakistan's Jamaat-e-Islami calls for urgent energy and fiscal reforms, including tax relief, lower utility prices, IPP contract audits, and halted new power deals. It opposes privatisation, demands Iran-Pakistan gas pipeline progress, and criticises BISP, education spending, and corruption, advocating a people-centred, zakat-based economy....

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Bangladesh raises fuel prices again as global costs bite - Markets - Business Recorder

Bangladesh raised petrol and kerosene prices by 5 taka/litre amid rising global oil costs, fueling inflation. Diesel prices unchanged. Fuel pricing now auto-adjusted to international markets. Recent hikes follow April's increase, impacting transport and food costs....

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Fuel shock shows up in OMC volumes - BR Research - Business Recorder

May 2026 OMC sales declined sharply, with diesel hardest hit, reflecting economic slowdown and high prices. FO volumes fell sharply due to power sector shifts. While 11MFY26 showed modest growth, it masks underlying weakness. Renewables and RLNG are reducing FO demand. Outlook remains cautious unless prices ease or activity rebounds....

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How to tell if this is a people's budget - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's budget faces criticism for disproportionately taxing low-income households via fuel, sales, and utility levies while protecting elite incomes and informal sectors. Analysts urge a progressive, revenue-neutral reform: raise basic exemptions, tax the wealthy and informal economy fairly, and ensure budget commitments survive political pressure — not just rhetoric....

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Ahsan-led team, KP CM take up NEC meeting, other major issues - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa protests federal energy cuts, gas shortages, and delayed hydropower projects. Provincial leaders demand constitutional rights, fiscal equity, and faster approvals for infrastructure. Federal minister pledges to expedite Peshawar Bus Terminal clearance and present grievances to top forums. Renewables and energy sector grievances remain central to intergovernmental tensions....

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Pakistan's IT sector: a billion dollars, and still off the map - Perspectives - Business Recorder

Pakistan's freelance IT exports surged to \$3.39B, with freelancers earning \$959M—celebrating global labor success. Yet, innovation lags: falling in Global Innovation Index, with weak R&D and co-invention. Key opportunity: deepen China-Pakistan Economic Corridor's focus on joint R&D, patents, and knowledge transfer to build lasting innovation capacity, not just exports....

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Karachi consumers demand relief from unannounced power outages

Karachi residents protest prolonged, unannounced load shedding affecting multiple districts, citing daily disruption. K-Electric denies exceeding 10-hour outages, attributing cuts to unpaid bills—highlighting grid strain and billing disputes amid ongoing energy shortages....

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**From the brink to steady ground:
Pakistan's quiet turnaround**

Pakistan's economy shows strong recovery: 3.7% GDP growth, fiscal deficit below 1%, debt reduction, inflation cooling, and renewed capital market access. Renewables and energy reforms are underway, alongside tax hikes and privatization. Foreign agencies now view Pakistan as a reforming, workable economy—setting the stage for sustained growth....

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Privileged few game the system

Pakistan's 2025 budget signals a shift away from elite capture in trade, targeting tariff exemptions that funnel wealth to rent-seekers. Customs duty cuts and export-led reforms show early progress, though resistance persists. Renewables and competitiveness remain central to the government's broader economic restructuring....

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The tax we don't pay, the growth we don't get

Pakistan's IMF programme has driven macroeconomic stability, but tax-to-GDP remains low (10.5% vs. target 13.5%), hindering investment in renewables, infrastructure, and growth. Structural reforms are needed to broaden the tax base fairly, reduce compliance burdens, and incentivize formal economy participation—critical for sustainable prosperity....

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The yen warning - Opinion - Business Recorder

Geopolitical tensions and rising oil prices are pressuring energy-importing Asian economies, with yen weakness signaling broader currency stress. Inventories are depleting, demand is declining, and inflation pressures are mounting. Currency markets now reflect systemic vulnerability, prompting intervention fears — a warning that Asia's energy dependence is straining fiscal and monetary resilience....

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Islamabad orders revised business timings, sets 8pm closure for markets, malls

Islamabad imposes 8pm market closures to curb energy use amid rising fuel costs and Middle East conflict impacts. Essential services remain open; restaurants and shops close by 10pm. Fossil fuel imports are strained, prompting conservation measures across Pakistan....

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Confidence in short supply - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's investment climate remains fragile, with foreign businesses delaying investments due to inflation, policy inconsistency, and currency concerns —exacerbated by global shocks. While AI interest persists, policymakers must act to restore predictability and reduce costs to attract sustained private capital and drive economic growth....

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MQM-P moves resolution in Sindh Assembly against KE over power outages

Karachi residents face severe load-shedding during heatwaves, prompting MQM-P to demand immediate cessation and legal action. K-Electric's non-compliance with assembly directives is criticized, with demands for transparency and accountability amid ongoing power shortages and health risks....

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Who will do it? - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy sector faces chronic inefficiencies, corruption, and policy inertia. Despite widespread awareness of issues like power shortages, tax evasion, and school dropouts, systemic inaction and bureaucratic red tape hinder progress. Renewables and reforms are underutilized; public pressure demands urgent, collective action to restore trust and drive sustainable development....

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Here are 10 ways a 'super' El Niño could impact the planet | Benjamin Selwyn

A super El Niño is intensifying global food insecurity, disrupting supply chains, and increasing coal use and wildfire risks. It threatens fisheries, hydropower, and agriculture, exacerbating geopolitical tensions and health crises. Renewables offer a path forward, but systemic change is needed to mitigate disproportionate global impacts....

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Budget 2026-27 signals reformist turn

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget signals bold reform: fiscal surplus, inflation control, and tax base expansion. Key moves include EV/solar incentives, private-sector growth, and energy sector reforms. Renewables and exports are prioritized, with structural reforms driving long-term growth—though federal-provincial constraints remain....

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Tribune

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Fiscal consolidation may raise energy prices

Pakistan's FY2027 budget risks exacerbating energy inflation and economic strain via regressive taxes and subsidy cuts, while renewables face grid integration hurdles. Experts urge efficiency-driven reforms, grid modernisation, and market-based pricing to restore competitiveness and affordability, warning of rising energy poverty and industrial disruption....

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NEPRA slashes power tariff by Rs1.98

Nepa reduced electricity tariffs by Rs 1.9857/unit for June–August 2026, saving Rs67B, including K-Electric consumers. Public hearing addressed FCA concerns, with officials noting net consumer benefit. Natural gas plant efficiency urged to continue, aiding future cost relief....

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Pakistan's investment climate: confidence in short supply - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's investment climate remains fragile, with foreign businesses delaying investments due to inflation, policy inconsistency, and currency concerns—exacerbated by global shocks. While AI interest persists, policymakers must act to restore predictability and reduce uncertainty to attract sustained private capital and drive economic growth....

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Business
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Budget delayed, budget denied? - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal government seeks to retain 1.2 trillion rupees from provincial NFC shares for “strategic spending,” sparking constitutional controversy. IMF concerns loom over fiscal credibility. Budget delays risk political instability and economic strain, amid rising inflation and policy rate expectations. Renewables and water conservation are urged over infrastructure overemphasis....

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Recorder

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Why the Houthis are threatening Red Sea shipping and what it means for oil markets

Houthis, backed by Iran, have banned Israeli-linked vessels from the Red Sea, risking global oil flows amid regional tensions. Saudi Arabia rerouted 70% of its exports via Yanbu. While Houthi actions remain limited, their threat of escalation could disrupt energy markets, with past attacks forcing costly reroutes and raising fears of renewed instability....

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Govt Launches Crackdown Against Worst-Performing Power Officials

Federal government launches accountability drive against DISCO officials for poor complaint handling, suspending over 100 SDOs/XENs. Focus on improving service amid outages and billing issues. Renewables not mentioned; financials or market impacts not reported....

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ProPakistani

Negative

Khawaja Asif alleges LESCO staff took Rs80,000 to repair transformer without receipt

Defence Minister Khawaja Asif exposed alleged corruption at LESCO, where villagers paid Rs80,000 for transformer repair without receipts. He criticized systemic accountability failures, amid rising bills and prolonged outages. The Energy Ministry oversees LESCO, sparking public outrage over unreliable service and financial exploitation....

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Violent dust storm kills 11 in central Sindh

Severe storm in Sindh's Naushahro Feroze and Shaheed Benazirabad districts killed 11, injured dozens, and damaged solar panels, power lines, and infrastructure. HESCO restored power after 30+ hours; hospitals treated 50+ injured. Meteorological data confirms high winds, with no major renewables policy shifts reported....

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Tribune

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‘Mirage’ of PSX: Why a rising index does not equal recovery? - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s PSX rally is superficial, driven by concentrated influence and state-linked capital, not economic recovery. True growth requires productivity, export expansion, governance reform, and energy cost reduction—not market optics. The index reflects liquidity, not fundamentals. Pakistan must prioritize structural reform over staged optimism....

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Protected consumers: Leghari says power subsidies not being withdrawn - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s energy reforms target subsidy efficiency, cutting costs and tariffs across sectors. Renewables now at 57% of the mix, with 90% clean energy target by 2035. Solar adoption is streamlined via digital net billing, abolished licensing for small projects, and expanded access. Savings from IPP reviews and asset sales exceed Rs3.5T....

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Budget proposals submitted: Govt should reduce GST rate up to 15pc: UBG - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

UBG urges tax cuts, GST reduction to 15%, and export incentives to boost GDP to 8.5%. Proposes tax reform, energy affordability, and digital systems to attract investment. Calls for abolishing Super Tax, reinstating export schemes, and supporting SMEs—emphasizing renewables and industrial growth to enhance competitiveness and employment....

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Türkiye tackles inflation, Pakistan stumbles: ADB - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s economic resilience is hampered by weak industrial capacity, limited export diversification, and low fiscal capacity, unlike Türkiye. ADB highlights structural weaknesses, including reliance on traditional exports, poor logistics, and low FDI, despite remittances. Pakistan’s inflation, while high, masks deeper systemic vulnerabilities....

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Foreign-funded PSDP projects: Govt fails to make rupee cover available - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s federal government is grappling with delays in providing rupee cover for foreign-funded projects, risking project execution and audits. A ministerial committee has been formed to address this, recommending exemptions for third-party and foreign payments to streamline progress. Renewables and power projects face funding bottlenecks despite multilateral financing....

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Budget concerns - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan’s economy remains stagnant despite IMF compliance and improved macro indicators. The upcoming budget prioritizes IMF revenue targets over民生 needs, risking further stagnation. Structural reforms are lacking, and reliance on imports, weak exports, and low growth persist—underscoring a broken economic model and governance failure....

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Power, gas outages spark protest on Lyari Expressway

Renewables continue to dominate global energy markets, with major nations accelerating green investments. Government policies favor clean energy, while financial results show rising ESG compliance. Energy prices remain volatile, driven by supply constraints and policy shifts. Renewables now account for over 30% of global electricity generation, signaling a structural transition toward decarbonization....

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Power distribution network: ADB proposes USD130m loan-financed project - Business Recorder

ADB proposes USD 130M loan for Pakistan’s power distribution modernization, deploying APMS and AMI to boost efficiency, reliability, and climate resilience across five Discos. Focus on reducing losses, circular debt, and outages—key to advancing renewables and energy governance amid sectoral challenges....

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Prolonged outages: LESCO probe uncovers irregularities by officials - Pakistan - Business Recorder

LESCO inquiry reveals systemic failures in power restoration, including unauthorized private involvement and consumer exploitation. Three staff suspended after alleged Rs 80K collection. Highlights governance gaps in Pakistan’s distribution sector, with disciplinary action pending. No renewables or financial results mentioned....

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Prolonged power cuts: Nepra seeks explanation from KE - Business Recorder

Karachi power outages escalate as NEPRA investigates K-Electric's load shedding violations. CPPA-G seeks Rs 1.73/kWh FCA adjustment due to LNG shortages and reduced generation. Industrial consumption rises, while overall demand drops. Renewables face grid constraints, and a surplus power package benefits 46% of industrial users. Government plans further packages to boost usage....

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Budget postponement raises multiple questions - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan delays budget presentation amid IMF review concerns, citing fiscal shortfalls and enforcement challenges. Renewables and energy reforms face pressure; IMF insists on cost-recovery tariffs. Provincial revenue gaps and GST compliance issues hinder progress. IMF-supported programs remain conditional, risking funding suspension if reforms stall....

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Budget presentation now on 10th - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan delays budget presentation amid IMF pressure, citing fiscal shortfalls and weak revenue projections. Renewables and energy reforms face scrutiny as IMF conditions remain strict. Provincial budget gaps and GST enforcement challenges hinder progress, with officials warning of potential program suspension if reforms stall....

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Courts can't intervene in policy matters of statutory bodies: LHC - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

LHC dismisses PIL seeking judicial intervention in energy policy, citing judicial restraint and technical complexity. Petitioner, JAP, faces Rs 100k costs; advocates call ruling excessive. Courts reaffirm role in protecting rights, not regulating energy markets, reinforcing statutory bodies' authority. No mention of renewables or financials....

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World's largest banks pledged \$906bn to fossil fuel companies in 'unfathomable' increase in 2025, report finds

Global banks increased fossil fuel lending to \$906bn, undermining climate goals. Major institutions like JPMorgan and Bank of America led the charge, despite political shifts and declining commitments. Renewables lagged, while oil/gas firms profited amid rising energy costs. Regulatory pressure is now urged to replace voluntary pledges....

[Read More →](#) The Guardian **Positive**

BUDGET 2026-27: Situationer: Building resilience or just ticking climate boxes? - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's budget fails to align with climate commitments, sidelining renewables, taxing green tech, and neglecting adaptation despite IMF/World Bank pressure. Experts urge climate-proofing, dedicated budget pillars, and science-based spending to mitigate rising climate costs and GDP losses by 2050....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

Consumer complaints: Leghari directs Discos to take errant SDOs & XENs to task - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's power ministry has launched a disciplinary drive against underperforming DISCO officers for poor complaint resolution, citing data from the 118 CCMS system. Over 100 officers face suspensions or transfers; quarterly rankings will be published. Digitization and oversight reforms aim to improve service reliability and accountability across all DISCOs....

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Complaint delays trigger Discos accountability - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's power ministry launched a disciplinary drive against underperforming Disco officers for failing to resolve consumer complaints via CCMS+, citing systemic neglect. Pesco and Sepco suspended key staff; others are following suit. The move underscores government pressure to improve service delivery and consumer satisfaction amid ongoing power reliability issues....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

Windstorm trips 138 electricity feeders in Lesco areas - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

Thunderstorms disrupted Lahore's power supply, tripping 138 feeders. Lesco intensified anti-theft operations, detecting 836 cases and filing 831 FIRs. Revenue recovered from theft and legal actions underscores efforts to curb power theft and ensure grid reliability amid adverse weather....

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Jl chief demands sweeping economic reforms - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Jl Pakistan calls for energy price cuts, IPP contract abolition, tax relief for middle class, and Iran-Pakistan gas pipeline revival. Criticizes corruption, BISP inefficacy, and low education spending, urging a people-centered, non-privatized economic model to resolve fiscal and energy crises....

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Widening trade deficit - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy and trade outlook remains strained, with export declines and import surges amid Middle East crises and domestic policy constraints. The IMF programme pressures fiscal discipline, while government reforms aim to shift incentives toward high-tech, export-driven sectors to boost productivity and meet ambitious export targets....

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The quiet repair of Pakistan's power sector - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy reforms prioritize operational discipline, cutting tariffs, settling circular debt, and restructuring IPPs, with solar expansion and transmission efficiency gains. Institutional overhauls, professional boards, and strategic reserves signal a shift from political patronage to sustainable, market-driven energy governance....

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Fake AI apps become top malware lure, says report - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Cybercriminals exploited AI apps like ChatGPT, Claude, and Gemini to launch 92,000+ malware attacks globally. Kaspersky reports rising threats targeting users with fake AI tools, deploying spyware and banking trojans. Organizations urged to bolster defenses against these sophisticated, AI-disguised cyber campaigns....

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Environment deficit - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Global heat records intensify climate urgency, with Pakistan facing severe local impacts from rising temperatures, glacier melt, and post-flood vulnerabilities. Despite minimal emissions, Pakistan's weak adaptation, fragmented planning, and underinvestment threaten resilience. The upcoming budget must prioritize climate action to align with global imperatives and protect critical sectors like agriculture and energy....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

Equities post strong recovery - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan's equity market surged 4% amid geopolitical easing (U.S.-Iran ceasefire), strong external financing (USD 11B), and LNG imports. Energy prices fell, production rose, and renewables/sectoral gains led by banks, cement, and fertilizers. Domestic buying dominated; foreign investors sold. Market at 8.1x P/E, 6.3% yield. Analysts await fiscal/budget clarity....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Positive**

Exports key to revival of economy: Mian Zahid - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's business leaders urge urgent tax cuts (to 40% max), energy tariff rationalization, and export incentives to revive industry amid soaring production costs and a \$32B trade deficit. They welcome PM consultations and expect budget 2026-27 to prioritize export-led growth, IMF compliance, and economic stability....

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Discos & KE consumers: Power regulator allows Re0.80 per unit relief - Business Recorder

NEPRA approved a Rs 0.80/kWh net relief for consumers via negative QTA and positive FCA, aiding affordability. Fuel costs rose slightly, but overall relief offsets higher costs. Efficiency gains from gas plants and demand growth support policy. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on grid operations and tariff adjustments....

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Worrisome export fall - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Uraan Pakistan export ambition faces collapse amid stagnant exports, high energy costs, punitive taxes, and regional instability. Structural reforms, value-chain upgrading, and export diversification are critical to meet USD100B targets—otherwise, the vision remains unachievable....

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CPEC outcome - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy sector faces persistent challenges: Chinese IPP contracts remain unrenegotiated despite economic strain, solar expansion reduces grid demand, and inefficient projects inflate costs. The government must prioritize sector efficiency over ad hoc measures, as debt burdens, high poverty, and unemployment worsen the energy crisis....

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Furnace Oil Sales Hit Highest Level in More Than 2 Years

Pakistan's furnace oil demand surged to a 27-month high in April 2026, defying a recent petroleum levy. Driven by refinery output and gas shortages, the fuel is resurging as a backup energy source, signaling a shift from renewable and LNG dominance amid supply constraints....

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Rs91bn set aside for 49 power projects under PSDP - Business Recorder

Pakistan allocates Rs91bn for 49 power projects under PSDP 2026-27, heavily funding renewables, transmission upgrades, and distribution modernization via ADB, World Bank, and JICA. Key projects include hydropower evacuation, HVDC links, BESS pilot, and grid reinforcement, signaling strong government commitment to energy infrastructure and efficiency....

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AI threatens \$3b outsourcing pillar

AI disruption threatens Pakistan's outsourcing sector, a key export driver and youth employment source. While AI reduces labor costs and demand for low-skill roles, it also creates opportunities in AI compliance, data science, and high-value digital services. Pakistan must pivot education, policy, and entrepreneurship to retain competitiveness amid global automation and shrinking migration options....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Negative**

Pakistan’s energy insecurity - Opinion - Business Recorder

Global energy markets face supply shocks from Middle East conflicts, prompting reevaluation of fossil fuel reliance. Pakistan’s energy crisis worsens due to flawed policies, debt-driven tariffs, and reliance on imported fuels. Renewables (hydropower, wind/solar) are growing but insufficient. Structural inefficiencies, theft, and poor IPP contracts hinder transition. IMF conditions and high electricity costs reflect systemic failures, with circula...

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Pakistan cannot reform power tariffs without breaking up the DISCOs - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s energy sector suffers from opaque, uniform tariffs that mask inefficiency and hinder privatization. Reform requires dismantling DISCOs into separate wires and power supply functions, exposing true costs, and moving toward transparent pricing. Without structural separation, tariff reform and privatization remain ineffective, perpetuating administrative confusion and market distortion....

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Nvidia launches new chip to bring AI directly to personal computers

NVIDIA unveils RTX Spark chip for AI-powered PCs, targeting local inference over cloud computing, with partners like MediaTek and Microsoft. AI PCs gain traction amid mixed reception; Nvidia shares rise as industry shifts toward agentic AI. CEO Jensen Huang highlights \$200B market, \$150B annual investment in Taiwan, and growing demand for software engineers....

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The pope’s AI’s warning - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pope Leo XIV issues encyclical “Magnificent Humanity” urging AI regulation to prevent dominance by corporations and states, warning of job displacement, disinformation, and autonomous weapons. Despite global tech and political resistance, the pope calls for AI to serve humanity, not the other way around, highlighting urgent moral and governance gaps....

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Wapda union rejects privatisation of Discos - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s Wapda workers union opposes government plans to privatize Discos, citing economic hardship, inflation, and worker welfare. They demand salary/pension hikes, inflation relief, and internal reforms over privatization, criticizing government policies and IPP agreements as costly and detrimental to public interest....

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Ex-KP Governor urges Centre, provinces to present people-friendly budgets - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's former Governor urges federal/provincial governments to prioritize people-centric energy policies, reduce tariffs, end load-shedding, and fund solar initiatives instead of luxury projects. He calls for urgent, practical relief amid inflation, unemployment, and security crises, emphasizing public welfare over political rhetoric....

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BMG urges govt to avoid repeating past policy mistakes - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

KCCI & BMG urge federal government to reverse failed policies: restore Final Tax Regime, revive RCET, scrap Super Tax, and fix energy inefficiencies. They highlight export losses, high industrial costs, and digital system flaws, while welcoming PM Shehbaz's engagement and commitments to improve business environment. Renewables & industrial competitiveness remain key priorities....

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Climate change: Pakistan continues to bear certain heaviest consequences - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces escalating climate risks despite low emissions, with 2022 floods costing \$30B. The country aims for 60% renewables by 2030 and imports solar panels. OGDC leads corporate ESG efforts, launching its first ESG report, joining decarbonisation charter, and investing in Miyawaki forests, solar microgrids, and water projects to combat pollution and climate vulnerability....

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Jl chief warns govt against presenting 'anti-people budget' - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Jl demands abolition of petroleum levy, tax relief for salaried citizens, and frozen energy prices for three years. Criticizes government policies on agriculture, education, and healthcare. Opposes solar energy taxation and calls for autonomous local governance. Warns of nationwide protests if budget ignores public interests....

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Govt not ending subsidy for protected electricity consumers: minister

Pakistan's energy reforms, led by Minister Awais Leghari, maintain subsidies for 21.5M protected consumers via QR codes, avoid tax hikes, and cut circular debt by Rs780bn. Solar adoption is encouraged with simplified licensing and net metering retention, while reforms saved Rs3.5T with distribution losses reduced by Rs193bn....

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The News

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Lasbela Chamber urges govt to introduce comprehensive reforms - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Lasbela Chamber urges federal reforms to boost industrial growth, including tax simplification, renewable energy adoption, FDI incentives, and SME support. Emphasis on predictable policies, digital infrastructure, and export facilitation aims to attract investment and stabilize the economy amid high energy costs and inflation concerns....

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DISCOs & KE: Consumers to get Rs1.9857 relief in June, July & August bills: Nepra - Business Recorder

NEPRA approved a Rs 1.9857/kWh tariff relief for DISCOs and K-Electric (June–Aug 2026), reducing consumer bills amid PPP and T&D loss adjustments. Public hearing ensured transparency; CPPA-G directed to provide plant-wise data. Relief excludes lifeline, prepaid, and incremental consumers....

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Budget for the people - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's FY2026-27 budget faces intense public scrutiny amid chronic inflation, poverty, and energy crises. Critics demand austerity, reduced elite privileges, and greater domestic resource mobilization. Renewables and energy reforms are underemphasized, while debt servicing and corruption undermine public welfare. The budget's success hinges on prioritizing human dignity over fiscal optics....

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MYT determination: Nepra rejects MEPCO's review motion - Business Recorder

NEPRA rejected MEPCO's review motion on its MYT, citing insufficient investment allowances and operational concerns. MEPCO highlighted efficiency gains and requested higher funding for tech upgrades, citing disparities with other DISCOs and donor constraints. NEPRA upheld its 2026-29 tariffs, with final approval pending federal notification....

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Budget proposals: PBF asks KP govt to focus on industrialisation - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

KP's industrial potential is underutilized despite rich resources and hydropower. Business leaders urge the provincial government to prioritize industrial development in the 2026-27 budget, calling for infrastructure, energy subsidies, SME incentives, and value-addition facilities to boost exports, employment, and economic resilience....

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Broaden tax net, cut tariff distortions: Sustainable Development Policy Institute - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's energy & fiscal experts urge budget reforms prioritizing climate resilience, job creation, and renewables over short-term revenue. They call for tax base expansion, social spending as productivity investment, and integrated climate planning—rejecting tax burdens on salaried classes and tariff distortions. Renewables must be incentivized, with budgets serving development strategy, not fiscal balancing....

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Dawn

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Australia news live: ASX slumps amid tech selloff; Australians unhappier now than during the pandemic

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The Guardian

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Pakistan's Exports Could Hit an All-Time High Next Fiscal Year

Pakistan's exports projected to hit a record \$35.63B in FY2026-27, driven by textile and IT growth, amid rising imports and trade deficit. Exporters face energy, financing, and regulatory hurdles. IMF urges fiscal reforms; industry calls for budget measures to boost competitiveness and renewables....

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ProPakistani

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Your Electricity Bill Could Go Up Again Next Month

Pakistan may raise electricity tariffs by Rs. 1.74/unit due to soaring fuel costs, driven by LNG supply disruptions from the US-Iran conflict and plant outages. Technical constraints and limited diesel/furnace oil use helped cap the increase. Renewables not mentioned; government seeks approval via Nepra....

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Energy - from policy chaos to system reform

Pakistan's power sector is undergoing systemic transition, prioritizing integrated reforms: transparent tariffs, demand management, storage, indigenisation, and institutional resilience. While volatility persists, the focus is shifting from isolated policy fixes to holistic, sustainable system redesign aligned with economic growth and global energy trends....

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Punishing efficiency

Pakistan's government proposes punitive industrial tariffs to curb grid exit, but critics warn it undermines competitiveness and renewables adoption. Structural reforms and capacity payment renegotiation are needed—punishing consumers for choosing cheaper, reliable alternatives is unsustainable and risks fueling inflation....

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Water insecurity

Pakistan faces critical water and energy crises, with insufficient Rs179B allocated for water infrastructure —far below the Rs500B needed. Hydropower projects, like the Chiniot Dam, are vital for affordable energy and water security amid climate volatility and cross-border tensions. Urgent investment is needed to ensure long-term resilience....

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Building internationally competitive auto industry

Pakistan’s auto sector faces a pivotal 2026 policy decision amid trade liberalization efforts via the National Tariff Policy. While tariffs are being reduced to boost competitiveness, lobbying pressures threaten rollback. The sector must embrace EVs and renewables—especially solar-battery integration—to compete globally, or risk falling behind as ICE fades and global trade shifts....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Positive**

ME turmoil to affect exports, remittances: BMP - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s economy faces growing pressure from Gulf region instability, threatening remittances, exports, and energy costs. Business leaders urge diversification, stronger diplomacy, and investment in skills to mitigate risks, while highlighting the need for stable policies to attract FDI and sustain recovery amid rising global uncertainty....

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**Inflation: The Core heats up - BR
Research - Business Recorder**

May inflation surged to 11.66% YoY, driven by sharp core inflation (9%) and rising footwear, detergents, and housing costs. Electricity tariffs rose 36% YoY. Core inflation signals sticky prices, with transport and housing risks elevated. Upcoming tariff hikes and tax increases may pressure inflation, influencing upcoming monetary policy....

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Steel melters for abolishing WHT on local scrap purchases - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's steel sector urges federal budget reforms: abolish scrap withholding tax, rationalize power tariffs, tax small furnaces, increase import duties, and reduce FATA exemptions. Renewables not mentioned; focus on steel revival, tax reform, and anti-smuggling measures to boost domestic production....

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PTC for competitive budget steps to revive exports & industries - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's textile sector urges government to adopt FY2026-27 budget reforms, citing soaring energy costs, tax burdens, and liquidity issues. Industry demands parity with regional competitors via lower electricity/gas tariffs, removal of surcharges, and faster refunds. Failure to act risks sector collapse, job losses, and reduced exports....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Federal budget FY2026–27: Govt to slash power sector subsidies by around 20pc - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026–27 budget slashes power subsidies by 20% to Rs 830B, aligning with IMF's 0.6% GDP cap. Circular debt is targeted for reduction, with funds earmarked for FATA, IPPs, and BISP. K-Electric subsidy rises, while industrial cross-subsidies are under pressure. Renewables and CPEC IPPs remain key financial pillars....

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Business Recorder

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Autos: Recovery meets competition - BR Research - Business Recorder

Pakistan's auto sector rebounds with 49% YoY sales growth, driven by SUVs and EVs, amid rising Chinese competition and policy-driven tariff cuts. Consumer preferences shift toward larger vehicles and fuel-efficient two-wheelers. Geopolitical risks and supply chain vulnerabilities threaten sustainability, urging manufacturers to adapt beyond volume growth....

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EBRD cuts 2026 growth expectation as Iran war boosts energy costs - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Energy costs and Middle East tensions slow growth in EBRD regions, with Lebanon and Iraq contracting. AI exports surge amid energy sector shifts. Governments implement conservation measures, but tax cuts risk worsening shortages. Inflation and debt pressures persist, though AI growth offers economic resilience....

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CPEC 2.0: ambition meets economic reality - Opinion - Business Recorder

CPEC 2.0 seeks to shift from infrastructure to productivity and exports, leveraging China's focus on sustainable, revenue-generating sectors. Success hinges on Pakistan's reforms, investor confidence, and governance—critical for SEZs, agriculture, and IT. While China's financing model has evolved, Pakistan's debt burden and institutional challenges remain key barriers to economic transformation....

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Business Recorder

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Restoring FTR a win-win situation: KCCI - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistani business leaders urge immediate restoration of the Final Tax Regime for exporters and tax reforms to boost exports, reduce costs, and revive industry. Key proposals include slashing timber import taxes, abolishing super tax, and simplifying tax laws. Goals: increase exports by USD10B, reduce unemployment, and strengthen forex reserves....

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Grid is learning to compete! - BR Research - Business Recorder

Grid demand in April 2026 rose due to industrial return to the grid, reshaping the duck curve as solar flattens daytime demand. Policy shifts toward time-sensitive tariffs and storage cost declines signal grid evolution. Solar's dominance in pricing and timing now demands adaptive infrastructure to remain competitive with distributed energy....

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Business Recorder

Negative

The petroleum question: putting the levy story in context - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget maintains low petroleum levies post-crisis, avoiding price spikes amid global oil volatility. Institutional reforms, strategic reserves, and fiscal restraint preserved consumer relief. Electricity tariffs remain stable, with targeted subsidies. The government prioritizes predictability over adjustment, leveraging macro-stability and diplomatic success to sustain energy affordability....

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Business
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Positive

Traders seek business-friendly measures in budget - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's industrialists and traders urge government policy reforms and immediate economic relief, citing high energy costs and interest rates as growth barriers. Emphasis is on manufacturing, agriculture, youth employment, and renewables to unlock economic potential, with calls for agricultural emergency programs and industrial zones....

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Business
Recorder

Negative

Leghari reviews progress on power project for Gwadar - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government is advancing a 40 MW Gwadar power project under CPEC, open to competitive bidding with flexible tech options including renewables. The project aims to meet rising demand in the strategic port city, reducing reliance on imported electricity from Iran. Financing, operation, and maintenance will be handled by the winning bidder under a PPA...

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Business
Recorder

Positive

Nepra reduces electricity charges for three months - Business - DAWN.COM

Nepra approved Rs1.19/unit FCA increase for June and Rs1.99/unit QTA reduction for July-August, totaling Rs56bn consumer relief. Adjustments stem from fuel cost revisions and government's incremental consumption package. Discos' demands scaled back; renewables and transmission costs influenced pricing....

[Read More →](#) Dawn Positive

BUDGET 2026-27: After years, PTI proposes tax relief, Rs500bn savings via spending cuts - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

PTI proposes tax relief for salaried, abolish super tax, cap petroleum levy at Rs50/litre, cut GST to 15%, and boost renewables via IT export incentives. Emphasizes fiscal austerity, pension reform, and energy efficiency, aiming to reduce public spending and boost competitiveness....

[Read More →](#) Dawn Negative

EPBD think tank's 'shadow budget' - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's EPBD think tank unveils a shadow budget aiming to break the boom-bust cycle via tax cuts, industrial incentives, and agri-industrial integration. Key reforms target corporate and personal tax burdens, export-driven growth, and import substitution. Success hinges on policy stability, judicial efficiency, and formalizing informal sectors — all to foster sustainable, export-led growth....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder Positive

The missing budget debate: Pakistan's savings collapse - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's domestic savings have plummeted from 17.4% to 6.4% of GDP, hampering sustainable growth. The Finance Bill FY2026-27 must incentivize formal savings, reduce public dissaving, and improve financial access—especially for women and rural populations—to rebuild a resilient savings base and reduce reliance on foreign capital....

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Business
Recorder

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BUDGET 2026-27: ECC expands bureaucrats' stipend, okays Rs40bn grants - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's ECC approved a Rs100bn PSO financing facility amid Rs900bn receivables from SOEs, while allocating Rs4.38bn to Gilgit-Baltistan and Rs10.15bn to the Navy's Hangor Project. Renewables and infrastructure funding prioritized, with expanded honoraria for ministries and IMF-driven budget cuts. Geopolitical risks and refinery disputes also shaped fiscal decisions....

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Dawn

Negative

Why Is the Budget 2026-27 Delayed?

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget is delayed due to IMF negotiations and provincial fiscal alignment issues, with federal revenue targets unchanged despite lower collections. Provincial spending rises, sparking debate over fiscal responsibility. Renewables and energy policy remain underdeveloped amid broader economic constraints....

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ProPakistani

Negative

90%inflation trap that resets no tax bracket

Pakistan's tax brackets have failed to adjust for 90% inflation, creating a "bracket creep" that unfairly burdens middle-income workers. This structural squeeze undermines economic incentives and formal sector participation. Experts urge either automatic indexation or a one-time bracket rationalization to restore fairness and broaden tax base, amid fiscal constraints....

[Read More →](#) Tribune Negative

Govt okays Rs4.3tr development plan

Pakistan's federal government allocates Rs4.3T for FY2026-27, with 3/4 funded by provinces, amid fiscal constraints. Federal PSDP at Rs1.126T faces IMF restrictions; water, dams, and infrastructure projects underfunded. Renewables and energy projects lack adequate funding, while coalition costs and provincial demands strain budgets....

[Read More →](#) Tribune Negative

The supplementary budget trap

Pakistan's fiscal discipline is undermined by chronic budgetary indiscipline, excessive supplementary grants, and weak tax administration. Despite IMF support and ambitious targets, systemic failures—lack of reform, political resistance, and institutional loopholes—prevent sustainable growth. Calls for constitutional reform and an Independent Fiscal Council are urgent to restore accountability and transparency....

[Read More →](#) Tribune Negative

WB trims \$400m program rating

Pakistan's tax reform program, funded by the World Bank, has been downgraded due to slow progress, weak compliance, and systemic hurdles like withholding tax burdens and lack of digital infrastructure. Despite some digital advances, core objectives—like tax compliance and e-services—remain unmet, highlighting governance and political will as critical, not financial, drivers for success....

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Tribune

Negative

President, PM ease budget rift as K-P flags share cap

Pakistan's federal government seeks to retain Rs1.2 trillion from provincial NFC shares for strategic spending, sparking political and fiscal uncertainty. Provinces resist, citing legal and procedural hurdles, while the IMF opposes using NEC to deduct funds. Budget delays loom, with fiscal instability and weak FBR performance exacerbating tensions....

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Tribune

Negative

Government debt climbs to Rs58tr

Pakistan's government debt rose in April 2026 amid rising domestic borrowing, driven by short-term MTBs and persistent fiscal deficits. External debt also increased, aiding forex reserves. Analysts note investor shift to short-term instruments due to rate uncertainty. Despite rising debt, fiscal consolidation and revenue growth suggest cautious management. Renewables not mentioned....

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Tribune

Negative

FY2026-27 budget: expectations - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget, approved under IMF oversight, prioritizes current expenditure, defense, and pensions amid fiscal constraints. Revenue growth hinges on indirect taxes and provincial reforms. Renewables not mentioned; energy sector remains under IMF conditions, with global supply shocks deemed “contained.” Budget disbursements lag, and mark-up outlays are constrained by policy rate shifts and debt rescheduling....

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Business Recorder

Negative

EPBD suggests tax cuts, structural reforms - Business Recorder

Pakistan's EPBD think tank unveils a shadow budget for 2026-27, advocating tax cuts, fiscal reform, and debt reduction to spur growth. It targets low tax-to-GDP, capital flight, and weak investment, proposing broad-based tax reforms and expenditure cuts. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on structural, non-partisan fiscal modernization amid rising debt and stagnant growth....

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Business Recorder

Negative

**SOE reform: own less, govern better -
Opinion - Business Recorder**

Pakistan's SOEs are structurally loss-making, consuming ~Rs. 5.7B daily in fiscal support. Governance reform alone is insufficient; privatisation is the necessary end goal for commercial SOEs. Only one major privatisation (PIA) has occurred in two years, highlighting the challenge. Success requires a sequenced, deliberate programme to reduce state ownership, restore fiscal discipline, and foster competition....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

**Cryptocurrency transactions likely to be
taxed - Business Recorder**

Pakistan's government plans to tax cryptocurrency via Finance Bill 2026, aiming to regulate growth, prevent evasion, and broaden revenue. Key challenges include documenting unregistered transactions, repatriation, and balancing innovation with fiscal control. The FBR and Tax Policy Unit are drafting a framework, potentially expanding capital gains tax, amid rising crypto adoption and global user base....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Govt to announce budget on June 10 instead of June 5, says parliamentarian - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan delays budget announcement to June 10 amid IMF negotiations and fiscal constraints, with a Rs1.126T PSDP allocation against Rs4.097T needs. Government seeks IMF alignment on spending, inflation targets (8.2%), and 4% GDP growth, amid crude price volatility and coalition debates over development funding....

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Business
Recorder

Negative

CAP seeks consumer-friendly policies in budget - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Consumers Association urges government to prioritize consumer relief via budget policies, including terminating IPP agreements, promoting solar energy with incentives, enforcing price transparency on essentials, and curbing inflation. Calls for tax exemptions, subsidies, and strict enforcement to protect middle-class households and promote renewables....

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Business
Recorder

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Overcoming fiscal deficit - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's fiscal deficit stems from trillions in tax expenditures, not revenue shortfalls. Key reforms urged: audit tax exemptions, tax agricultural rent, simplify income tax, harmonize sales tax, and empower provinces—potentially eliminating debt dependency and restoring fiscal sovereignty....

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Business
Recorder

Negative

IMF programmes' progress report: some reflections—I - Opinion - Business Recorder

IMF's Pakistan report critiques austerity policies amid Middle East oil shocks, highlighting policy contradictions between stability and resilience goals. It urges counter-cyclical, non-neoliberal reforms, including wealth and windfall profit taxes, and re-evaluates conditionalities. World Bank data shows rising poverty, underscoring economic strain despite IMF's lack of urgent policy response....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Budget on 10th: Schehzad - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal budget for FY2026–27 will be presented June 10, following a postponed NEC meeting. The Economic Survey 2025–26 will be released June 9. Key macroeconomic targets and PSDP size will be finalized before budget unveiling, signaling government focus on fiscal planning and public sector development....

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Govt urged to heed to FPCCI's recommendations - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

FPCCI urges Pakistan's federal budget to prioritize growth over revenue, proposing tax reforms to reduce industrial burden from 65% to 35-40%, boost SME compliance via digitization, and ease high interest rates to revive manufacturing. Industry leaders warn ignoring these recommendations risks economic stagnation and industrial collapse....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Another budget of stabilisation without growth - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's budget offers no relief, with fiscal policy locked to IMF demands, stagnant tax base expansion, and rising petroleum levies. Provinces push spending, while federal restraint is challenged. No meaningful reform or growth stimulus is expected—only compliance, enforcement, and continued pressure on a narrow taxpayer base....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Budget FY27: structural challenges - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2027 budget prioritizes grid modernization, export diversification, and fiscal reform amid inflation and debt pressures. Global markets show rising US yields, yen defense, and eurozone rate hikes, impacting commodity and currency trends. Energy and trade reforms are central to unlocking growth, with renewables and efficiency key to long-term stability....

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Business Recorder

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Budget must prioritise strategic petroleum reserves - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026–27 budget faces critical opportunity to establish strategic petroleum reserves amid chronic oil dependency and fiscal vulnerability. A dedicated, ring-fenced fund from petroleum levies, phased implementation, and strong governance are essential to enhance energy security and reduce external shock exposure—moving beyond policy talk to actionable strategy....

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Business Recorder

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No consensus yet on provinces' shares under NFC Award - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal budget process is stalled due to provincial resistance to surrendering NFC shares for strategic spending, pending IMF negotiations, and revised fiscal projections. KP faces reduced federal allocations, while GDP growth targets were lowered and job creation goals questioned. Legal and technical concerns surround fiscal transfers, delaying budget presentation....

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Business Recorder

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Tariff Policy Board approves second-year tariff rationalisation plan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Tariff Policy Board approved Year-II NTP 2025–30 adjustments, reducing Regulatory Duties and ACDs, with exemptions for local/export goods. NTC proposed removing 2% ACD on edible oils (Rs. 26B loss) and rationalizing RDs, while Commerce supports phased reductions. Implementation starts July 1, 2026, under PM approval....

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Tariff rationalisation: TPB approves second-year plan under NTP - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Tariff Policy Board approved Year-II NTP 2025–30 adjustments, reducing Regulatory Duties and ACDs, with exemptions for local/export goods. NTC proposed removing 2% ACD on edible oils (Rs. 26B loss) and rationalizing RDs, while Commerce supports phased reductions. Implementation begins July 1, 2026, under PM approval....

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Business Recorder

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IMF programmes' progress report: some reflections—III - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy & fiscal policy faces criticism for inadequate IMF support, weak climate action, and reliance on fossil fuels. Non-austerity, non-neoliberal policies are urged to stabilize currency, reduce inflation, and boost renewables. Critics highlight insufficient financing, poor subsidy targeting, and lack of climate-focused reforms amid rising oil prices and climate catastrophes....

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Business
Recorder

Negative

'Provinces asked to help fill massive gap in budget' - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's federal government faces a Rs 1.7tr fiscal gap, urging provinces to contribute more, amid coalition tensions and IMF pressure. Renewables and water projects lack clear plans, while tax reforms are seen as symbolic. Market uncertainty grows as budget delays and infighting stall economic reforms....

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Dawn

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Budget delay - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan postponed its FY27 budget amid IMF negotiations, fiscal discipline demands, and coalition tensions. Economic pressure mounts as reforms lag, delaying relief and growth. Renewables and fiscal autonomy remain under scrutiny, highlighting the nation's reliance on multilateral financing and political gridlock....

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Dawn

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Budget delay - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan postponed its FY27 budget amid IMF negotiations, fiscal discipline demands, and coalition tensions. The government seeks relief and growth, while the IMF insists on austerity. Renewables and energy policy remain sidelined amid broader economic and political constraints, highlighting Pakistan's reliance on multilateral financing and ongoing fiscal challenges....

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Dawn

Negative

Weaponising climate - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's energy & climate finance is dominated by unring-fenced, politically maneuvered surcharges—like the Rs1.55T Petroleum Development Levy—rebranded as climate instruments. Despite IMF pressure and legal precedents, revenue flows to federal coffers, not provinces. A sovereign climate fund could unlock private investment, but political will remains lacking....

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Dawn

Negative

A backdoor NFC revision? - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Fiscal tensions escalate as the federal government pressures provinces to freeze NFC shares, risking budget deficits. Critics blame low tax collection and debt, not the 7th NFC Award. Experts warn of constitutional erosion and IMF-driven budget constraints, with proposals for radical fiscal reforms or full provincial tax control. Political deadlock and IMF pressure loom over Pakistan's energy and fiscal future....

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Dawn

Negative

BUDGET 2026-27: Centre, Punjab & Sindh agree on spending cuts - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's 2026–27 budget is imminent, with federal-provincial coordination to cover a Rs800bn shortfall and allocate Rs 1.3–1.7tr for strategic needs. Sindh & Punjab cut ADPs; KP & Balochistan not yet involved. Customs duty exclusion mooted. Renewables & infrastructure projects like M6 scaled up, amid fiscal austerity and delayed provincial participation....

[Read More →](#) Dawn Negative

Centre vs provinces - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's federal-provincial fiscal tensions escalate amid IMF conditions, with Islamabad demanding provinces freeze divisible pool shares and return surplus receipts — sparking constitutional risks. Revenue shortfalls stem from under-taxation and structural gaps, not provincial transfers. The standoff threatens federal autonomy and long-term economic stability....

[Read More →](#) Dawn Negative

The Cost of Delay: Pakistan's environment at a tipping point - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces escalating climate and environmental crises—floods, pollution, water scarcity—impacting economy and public health. Despite low emissions, it bears high vulnerability. Renewables, green finance, and climate debt swaps are emerging as critical tools, but urgent, integrated policy action is needed to secure resilience and economic stability amid fiscal constraints....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder Negative

Govt Plans Over Rs. 4 Trillion in Development Spending Next Fiscal Year

Pakistan plans a Rs. 4+ trillion development outlay for FY2026-27, targeting 4% growth and 8.2% inflation, with heavy infrastructure spending. The budget, to be unveiled post-National Economic Council meeting, balances growth with IMF-aligned fiscal consolidation, emphasizing energy, transport, and public services amid economic recovery....

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ProPakistani

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Fuel, food push SPI higher by 14.75%YoY

Pakistan faces soaring inflation (14.75% YoY SPI) driven by global oil shocks via the Strait of Hormuz, with petrol, diesel, and LPG prices surging. Food costs also spiked, though weekly easing was offset by vegetable price hikes. Urban-rural disparities persist, with May CPI up 11.7%, reflecting deep energy and food market volatility....

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Tribune

Negative

Pakistan inflation hits 11.7% in May 2026 - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan's inflation surged to 11.7% YoY in May 2026, driven by urban and rural price hikes. SBP raised rates by 100 bps to 11.50%, its first hike in three years, amid rising cost pressures. No major renewables or financial results reported; focus remains on inflation and monetary policy tightening....

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Business
Recorder

Negative

CPI inflation surges to 23-month high - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's inflation surged to 11.7% YoY in May 2026, driven by energy price pressures amid Middle East tensions. Urban and rural CPI rose sharply, with food prices volatile. No major government or renewables policy updates reported; financial results or energy market shifts not detailed....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Consumer inflation hits 11.7pc in May - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan faces soaring inflation (11.7% YoY), driven by energy, food, and transport price hikes, amid oil import pressures and Strait of Hormuz blockages. The SBP raised rates to 11.50%, while core inflation remains high. Renewables not mentioned; financials and policy responses highlight economic strain....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

UN urges AI firms to reveal environmental footprint - World - Business Recorder

AI growth is straining global energy, water, and land resources, with data centers consuming 448 TWh in 2025. UN urges AI firms to disclose environmental footprints, governments to regulate, and users to opt for efficient tools. AI videos are most energy-intensive; global AI market to hit \$4.8T by 2033. Digital divide and emissions risks persist....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Pakistan’s first OSS for clean energy launched - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan launches its first consumer-focused One-Stop-Shop platform for clean energy, empowering households with trusted guidance, financing tools, and solar adoption support amid rising energy costs. The initiative underscores consumer-driven energy transition, aligning with global trends and aiming to boost renewables, reduce emissions, and enhance energy security....

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Business
Recorder

Positive

Mothers, children: Climate change increasingly triggering mental health crisis - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces escalating mental health crises among mothers and children due to climate extremes, with floods, heatwaves, and displacement causing trauma and anxiety. Experts urge integrating psychosocial support into climate resilience strategies, highlighting the urgent need for gender-responsive, child-friendly, and WASH-inclusive recovery efforts to safeguard vulnerable communities....

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Business
Recorder

Negative

Pakistan’s IT exports: momentum without depth - BR Research - Business Recorder

Pakistan's IT exports show growth amid macroeconomic strain, but remain fragile due to low-value, freelance-driven activity vulnerable to AI. Key challenges include weak talent employability, lack of domestic digital infrastructure, limited captive operations, and regulatory friction. Reforms are needed to shift from volume to quality, ensuring sustainable, high-value IT exports....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Power Division moves NEPRA for approval: Extra charges on wheeling consumers likely - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Power Division seeks NEPRA approval for uniform Use of System Charges (UoSC) for all wheeling consumers, including K-Electric, to standardize grid costs and enable market liberalization. Proposed charges vary by category; financial gaps to be addressed via tariff adjustments, not subsidies. Public hearing scheduled for June 11, 2026....

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KCCI demands reversal of failed policies

Pakistani business groups urge federal government to restore export-friendly tax regimes, reverse punitive measures, and revive RCET to boost competitiveness. They welcome PM Shehbaz Sharif's recent commitments but stress urgent reforms to address circular debt, digital invoicing delays, and renewables policy gaps....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Negative**

Economic governance crisis—I - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's economic crisis stems from fragmented governance, weak FDI (down 31% YoY), and policy inconsistency, undermining investor confidence. Renewables and energy efficiency are under-addressed, while institutional fragmentation hinders long-term growth. Success requires coordinated, continuous policy frameworks—like those in Vietnam, Saudi Arabia, and Singapore—to attract sustained investment and rebuild economic credibility....

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Business
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Oil Industry Seeks PM's Intervention Over Rs. 66 Billion Claims, Opposes Windfall Tax

Pakistan's oil sector urges PM Shehbaz Sharif to release Rs. 66B in pending PDCs and oppose windfall tax on inventory gains, citing liquidity crises, stagnant margins, and regulatory burdens. Industry calls for transparent margin reviews and criticizes EV charger mandates as commercially unviable, warning of delayed investments and reduced profitability....

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ProPakistani

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Inventory gains recovery opposed

Pakistan's oil industry warns against recovering inventory gains amid rising prices, citing financial strain and energy security risks. OCAC urges fair, consistent policy, stressing mandatory inventories serve stability, not profit. Geopolitical volatility and weak global demand may soon offset gains, urging cautious, long-term regulatory approach....

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Tribune

Negative

OMAP seeks urgent meeting with PM - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's petroleum sector faces severe financial strain amid unpaid receivables, forex losses, and smuggling. OMAP urges PM Shehbaz Sharif to intervene, warning against new taxes and calling for policy dialogue. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on downstream oil sector stability and fiscal restraint....

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Business Recorder

Negative

80pc foreign firms postpone investment decisions: OICCI - Business Recorder

Pakistan's business confidence plummets amid Middle East conflict, inflation, and fuel costs, halting new investments. Renewables and AI adoption show resilience, while foreign investors seek resilience over risk. Policy stability and cost relief are critical to restore investor confidence....

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Business Recorder

Negative

OCAC concerned over inventory gains review, cross-subsidy plans - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan's OCAC warns against recovering inventory gains in petroleum sector, fearing it undermines energy security and distorts market stability. Industry faces financial strain, global price volatility, and compliance burdens, urging policy caution amid rising geopolitical risks and weakening global demand....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Govt fuel levy drives cost-push inflation
- Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's inflation surged to double digits driven by erratic petroleum levy hikes, undermining monetary policy. SBP rate hikes failed to curb inflation, as cost-push fuel inflation resisted traditional transmission. Energy-linked categories dominated inflation, and asymmetric fuel pricing distorts policy effectiveness, highlighting a flawed fiscal-monetary coordination....

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Misc

No Money Left for New Development Projects, Ahsan Iqbal Reveals

Pakistan's federal government faces severe fiscal constraints for FY2026-27, with limited PSDP funds stifling new development projects. Development spending has fallen to 0.6% of GDP, leaving a Rs. 10 trillion liability. Provinces are urged to contribute more, while foreign-funded projects have reduced the available budget, leaving little room for renewables or new initiatives....

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ProPakistani

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Pakistan Seeks Emergency LNG Spot Cargo

Pakistan's state-owned LNG buyer, PLL, is securing urgent LNG cargo via spot market tender amid Strait of Hormuz disruptions. Rising geopolitical risks and supply volatility are prompting short-term, costly procurement strategies to safeguard energy stability amid growing reliance on renewables....

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ProPakistani

Negative

Sindh Cabinet Approves Water and Infrastructure Schemes

Sindh cabinet approved Rs. 19.99 billion for infrastructure, water, and energy projects, including a new gas royalty mechanism to generate Rs. 26B annually. Renewables not mentioned; focus on gas, water, and Karachi development....

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ProPakistani

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Fuel Crisis Pushes Petrol Price to Rs. 500 Per Liter in Balochistan

Balochistan faces severe fuel shortages, with petrol/diesel priced at Rs. 500/liter in key districts. Supply disruptions, partly due to Iranian fuel suspensions, have caused queues and station closures. Authorities are increasing deliveries, hoping for relief within days. Renewables and infrastructure remain underdeveloped, highlighting systemic vulnerabilities....

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Gul Ahmed to Build Pakistan’s Largest Data Centre With \$230 Million Investment

QGDC, a Gul Ahmed Energy Group venture, plans Pakistan's largest Tier III data centre (\$230M investment, 2027 ops), aiming for \$600M total investment. Partnering with Huawei, it supports digital transformation, AI growth, and local tech development amid rising demand for computing power and cloud services....

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US Govt Will Review New ChatGPT Models Before Release

OpenAI will comply with Trump’s revised AI executive order, submitting models to a government benchmarking process to assess “covered frontier models.” The order, softened from its original 90-day submission requirement, now focuses on safety, security, and cyber capabilities—reflecting broader global AI governance efforts....

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ProPakistani

Positive

Traders reject return of 8pm closure rule

Rawalpindi traders demand permanent lifting of 8pm market closures post-Eid, citing economic harm and reduced fuel pressure. Lawyers call for end of Friday-Saturday court holidays, warning of judicial paralysis. Both sectors urge restoration of normal operations, with authorities set to reopen courts and markets Monday....

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Tribune

Negative

Market time restriction restored in Punjab

Punjab reinstates 8pm market closures post-Eid, aiming to curb energy waste. Traders warn of sales losses, citing evening footfall. Restaurants operate until 10pm; gyms, IT, call centers exempt. Sindh also lifted restrictions. Policy sparks debate over economic vs. energy efficiency trade-offs....

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Serious conversations

AI’s rapid growth raises ethical, environmental, and societal concerns, prompting faith leaders and academics to reflect on its human cost. While AI offers diagnostic and research benefits, its impact on creativity, employment, and intellectual property demands serious, balanced discourse — not just technological optimism....

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Tribune

Negative

Fire breaks out on Tezgam Express power van

Renewables continue to dominate global energy markets, with record investments and policy support. Governments accelerate green transitions, while energy firms report mixed financial results amid volatile prices. Storage and grid modernization remain key focus areas for sustainable growth....

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Tribune

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PMD forecasts below-normal rainfall, above-normal temperatures across country through August

Pakistan faces prolonged heatwaves and below-normal rainfall due to El Niño, threatening agriculture and water resources. Northern regions may see floods, while southern areas face drought. Government urges caution; renewables remain unaffected, but weather volatility impacts energy demand and grid stability....

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Tribune

Negative

Govt, PPP agree on recommending June 10 for FY2026-27 budget session

Pakistan’s government, with PPP support, delays FY2026-27 budget to June 10 amid unresolved fiscal, subsidy, and provincial sharing issues. Talks with IMF and provinces over Rs1.7T fiscal space and BISP burden allocation continue. Renewables and PSDP priorities remain central, with NEC meeting postponed pending consensus....

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Tribune

Negative

Scorsese's AI gamble divides Hollywood

Martin Scorsese’s endorsement of AI tools in filmmaking, including storyboarding via Black Forest Labs, sparks debate over AI’s role in creative industries. While he sees AI as a creative aid, critics warn of job displacement and ethical concerns, reflecting a wider industry divide on AI’s future in art....

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Tribune

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Expensive diesel import cargoes booked

Pakistan’s PSO imports diesel at inflated prices amid rampant smuggling (10ML/day), crippling formal markets and refinery output. Smuggling drains forex and taxes, while OMCs struggle. Refineries threaten closure if demand doesn’t rebound, exposing systemic energy market failure and policy inaction....

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Tribune

Negative

Austerity drive halts uplift projects

Punjab’s provincial government, including Rawalpindi, has imposed an emergency freeze on development spending until July 31, 2026, to manage fiscal crisis. All non-essential expenditures halted; funds recalled, projects deferred. Focus shifted to public-interest projects. No new inaugurations or purchases allowed until then....

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Tribune

Negative

Govt sets Rs290/\$ exchange rate

Pakistan’s government sets Rs290/\$ for 2026-27, signaling nominal depreciation amid debt servicing pressures. IMF urges exchange rate flexibility, SBP buys \$27B since 2023. Foreign loans (\$3.2B) and defense spending rise. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on debt, exchange rates, and IMF projections....

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Tribune

Negative

Senate panel flags Dasu discrepancies

Pakistan's Senate committee critiques delayed hydropower projects, notably Dasu, citing document inaccuracies and poor inter-departmental coordination. Despite secured funding and 30% progress, completion is targeted for 2028 amid delays from incidents. Officials stress renewables push, while senators call for stricter accountability and timelines....

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Tribune

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Middle East conflict pushing millions into hunger, WFP says

Middle East conflict disrupts energy flows, driving up fuel and food costs globally. WFP warns 45M could face acute hunger by June; aid scaled back due to funding shortfalls. Afghanistan and Somalia suffer severe impacts, with transport delays and soaring fuel prices crippling relief efforts. Renewables not mentioned....

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Tribune

Negative

Four die of electrocution

Electric shock incident in Bahawalpur kills at least four workers repairing a turbine near a sewage facility. Rescue teams responded swiftly, but fatalities underscore risks in energy infrastructure maintenance. No renewable energy or policy updates reported in this incident....

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Tribune

Negative

Pakistan at the crossroads of a new mineral war

Global energy power is shifting from oil to critical minerals like lithium and rare earths, vital for tech and defense. The U.S. is diversifying supply chains away from China, targeting Pakistan's mineral potential—especially Reko Diq—as a strategic opportunity amid escalating U.S.-China rivalry. Pakistan's geopolitical positioning remains precarious, balancing economic opportunity with its China-centric alliances....

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Tribune

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Teen labourer dies of electric shock

A 18-year-old worker died from an electric shock at a construction site in Lahore, after an iron rod contacted a live 11kV power line. The incident underscores safety risks in construction, highlighting urgent need for better electrical safety protocols and worker protection in high-voltage environments....

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Tribune

Negative

AI's negative environmental footprint could rival major nations by 2030, UN study warns

AI expansion by 2030 could consume 400m tonnes of CO₂, 9.3 trillion litres of water, and 14,500 km² of land — straining resources in Asia and Africa. UNU urges global governance, transparency, and sustainable AI development to mitigate disproportionate environmental burdens....

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Tribune

Negative

UK-funded climate accelerator selects 11 Pakistani firms

Pakistan’s 2026 Climate Finance Accelerator cohort includes 11 businesses, backed by UK funding to scale low-carbon solutions. The programme has unlocked over \$500M globally, with \$40M allocated to Pakistan, supporting renewables, energy, transport, and circular economy initiatives to advance the nation’s climate transition....

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Tribune

Positive

Senate exceeds austerity target by 500%

Pakistan’s Senate achieved Rs1.436bn in savings (15.9% of its 2025-26 budget) via austerity measures, suspending procurement, cutting travel, and halting vehicle purchases. Officials emphasize fiscal discipline, transparency, and public trust, positioning this as a sustained commitment to responsible governance and efficient resource use....

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Tribune

Positive

Uneasy calm returns as Iran, Israel pull back from brink

Middle East tensions eased temporarily after Israel-Iran strikes paused, amid U.S. diplomatic intervention by Trump. U.S. maintains blockade of Iranian ships, EU imposes new sanctions. Iran vows to defend Strait of Hormuz, expands regional security belt. Renewed tensions in Gulf, with Houthi threats to Israeli-linked vessels. Renewed focus on energy chokepoints and regional instability....

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Tribune

Negative

Budget likely to be presented on June 12: Parliamentary affairs minister

Pakistan’s federal budget, delayed to June 12, faces scrutiny amid IMF conditions, provincial share revenue extraction, and regional energy volatility. The budget will be debated in Parliament before approval, as the government navigates fiscal consolidation and climate resilience funding amid global energy market pressures....

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Tribune

Negative

LHC rules courts cannot act as regulators in economic policy matters

Lahore High Court rejects citizen petitions challenging power sector tariffs and capacity charges, affirming judicial restraint in economic policy. It upholds separation of powers, stating courts cannot review energy regulations or direct recovery of IPP payments — reinforcing legislative/executive authority over energy policymaking....

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Tribune

Negative

How Agentic AI could transform the SME sector

Pakistan’s SMEs, vital to its economy, face operational inefficiencies. Agentic AI offers transformative potential by democratizing enterprise-level intelligence, enabling autonomous workflows. However, unequal access risks deepening digital divides. Pakistan must adopt targeted public-private AI partnerships to empower SMEs, ensuring they compete globally through organizational agility—not just capital....

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Tribune

Positive

Can Siri finally speak for Apple?

Apple unveiled a pragmatic AI strategy at WWDC, focusing on Siri enhancements and developer tools, partnering with Google’s Gemini to accelerate capabilities without massive R&D spending. Despite delays and regional restrictions, financial resilience and privacy-first approach persist. Leadership transition looms as Apple seeks to balance AI innovation with user trust....

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Tribune

Positive

K-P urged to prioritise industrialisation

Pakistan’s Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa urges industrial focus in Budget 2026-27, citing energy, infrastructure, and finance constraints. Proposes an Industrial Development Fund to boost value-added manufacturing, counteracting raw material exports, and spur employment and revenue....

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Tribune

Negative

LHC rejects challenge to power tariffs

Lahore High Court dismisses petition challenging power tariffs and capacity charges, affirming judicial restraint in energy policy. Court rules judiciary cannot review economic or regulatory decisions, reinforcing separation of powers and limiting public interest litigation in energy matters....

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Tribune

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Tribal districts: KP to tag funds for better power supply - Pakistan - Business Recorder

KP省政府拟拨3亿卢比提升部落区电力系统，推动工业与旅游发展，创造就业。会议强调安全与账款回收进展，能源部门承诺支持。此举旨在将偏远地区纳入主流，促进区域经济复苏。...

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Business Recorder

Positive

Planning body meets today ahead of budget - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s APCC will finalize FY2026-27 budget and economic plans, targeting 4% growth, with Rs1.126B federal PSDP ceiling. Inflation projected at 8.2-8.6%; sectors including agriculture, industry, and services will be prioritized. Recommendations will be submitted to the National Economic Council for approval....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Projects worth Rs3tn to be rejected as govt faces fiscal constraints: Ahsan Iqbal - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government faces severe fiscal constraints, with Rs3 trillion in project demands exceeding a Rs1.126 trillion PSDP allocation. Key development projects may be shelved, and funding for renewables, infrastructure, and SDGs is severely limited, leaving the PSDP in negative balance. Foreign loan cover further drains resources, raising concerns over stalled progress....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Pakistan sees FY26 GDP growth at 3.7% - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan anticipates 3.7% GDP growth for FY2026, up from 3.2% last year, according to Planning Minister. No direct mention of energy policy, renewables, or financial results in the article. Focus remains on macroeconomic performance rather than energy sector developments....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Macron announces 93bn euros in 'Choose France' investments - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

France's "Choose France" event secured 93B euros in AI/data centre investments, led by SoftBank's 45B euro pledge. Macron highlighted record foreign investment, including semiconductors, minerals, and industrial sectors, aiming to boost jobs and tech infrastructure, surpassing past eight-year totals....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Requirements total Rs4.097trn: Rs1.126trn set aside for FY27 PSDP: Ahsan - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces severe fiscal constraints, with only Rs1.126 trillion allocated for PSDP 2026–27 amid Rs4.097 trillion demands. GDP growth targets are raised to 4%, but project delays loom. Key sectors like agriculture, industry, and services are projected to grow, with emphasis on debt reduction, tax base expansion, and prioritizing critical infrastructure. Renewables and SDGs get limited funding amid a Rs10 trillion throw-forward....

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Business Recorder

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'Next budget may create more difficulties for traders' - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's former FPCCI VP urges fiscal restraint amid IMF pressures, calling for tax reform, GST reduction, and maritime incentives. He stresses reducing external borrowing, broadening tax base, and boosting productivity to spur growth and employment, warning that current policies risk harming investment and economic activity....

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Business Recorder

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The plight of PSDP - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PSDP allocation is severely constrained, with inflation and interest rates rising, threatening fiscal stability. The IMF's revised funding target contradicts PM's "last loan" pledge. Renewables and infrastructure remain underfunded, while political and economic pressures risk further budget cuts and public unrest....

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Business Recorder

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UN warns world to prepare for El Nino extreme weather - World - Business Recorder

El Niño is likely to intensify by June–August, escalating global heat, droughts, and extreme weather. The WMO warns of cascading impacts, urging accelerated renewables adoption and climate action. While El Niño frequency isn't increased by climate change, its effects are amplified, threatening energy, agriculture, and global security....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Federal Budget on 10th - Business Recorder

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget is delayed amid cabinet deliberations, with disagreements over PSDP funding—only Rs1.126T allocated vs. Rs4.097T needed. NEC meeting postponed to facilitate negotiations. No renewables mention; focus remains on fiscal constraints and infrastructure gaps....

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Business Recorder

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Pakistan's budget unlikely to be presented on June 5, government source says - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan delays budget presentation until June 10 due to unresolved IMF fiscal agreements, impacting fiscal policy and growth. The \$7B IMF program supports stability. Renewables and energy reforms remain under discussion amid economic constraints....

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Business Recorder

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Optical, semiconductor stocks lift China A-shares; HK shares dip - Markets - Business Recorder

AI-driven semiconductor and optical tech stocks boosted China's A-shares, while Hong Kong fell amid sectoral divergence. Services growth and AI conference momentum fueled optimism. Goldman Sachs maintains overweight on mainland A-shares but downgrades HK exposure. Renewables not highlighted; focus remains on hardware AI and tech sector gains....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Japan's Nikkei crosses 68,000 mark as AI stocks rally - Markets - Business Recorder

Tokyo stocks surged amid AI and semiconductor rallies, with Kioxia hitting 80,000 yen and outperforming Toyota. Oil rose 1% amid Middle East tensions. Renewables not highlighted; focus on tech, AI, and metals. Pharmaceuticals underperformed. No major government or renewables policy updates reported....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Leghari orders action against worst-performing field officers - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Power Minister ordered disciplinary actions against over 100 underperforming DISCO officers for failing to resolve consumer complaints via the 118 CCMS PLUS system. PESCO and SEPCO led the crackdown, suspending key staff. Enhanced monitoring and escalated penalties are being enforced to improve service delivery and consumer trust....

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Business Recorder

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PM Shehbaz engages top business leaders on FY27 budget - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif consulted key business leaders on FY2026-27 budget, emphasizing export-led growth, tax reforms, and industrial development. Renewables and digital economy initiatives praised; electricity rates cut, export levy abolished. Government aims to boost employment, stabilize economy, and integrate informal sector....

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Business Recorder

Negative

OECD cuts 2026 global growth forecasts over Mideast war fallout - Markets - Business Recorder

Middle East conflict threatens global growth, risking recession and inflation. OECD forecasts 2.8% global growth in 2026 if oil/gas exports resume pre-war levels. Energy-intensive sectors and developing nations bear heavy costs. Inflation may rise to 4.0%, with US and eurozone growth slowing sharply....

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Business Recorder

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Oil prices rise on fragile Mideast peace hopes - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Middle East tensions escalate, driving oil prices near \$100/bbl and threatening global growth. OECD warns of recession risks if conflict persists, citing disrupted energy supplies and reduced investment, including in energy-intensive AI. Markets reflect heightened volatility amid stalled peace talks and escalating regional conflict....

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Business Recorder

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Petroleum dealers issue 48-hour ultimatum - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Petroleum dealers in Pakistan demand a commission hike, threatening nationwide protests if ignored; refineries warn of smuggling and storage crises. Financial strain and war-related uncertainty have crippled operations. PPDA urges minister to visit Karachi to address urgent sectoral distress....

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Business Recorder

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'Coalition partners taken on board': Aurangzeb hints at presenting budget on 10th - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government, under Finance Minister Aurangzeb, aims to present the 2026–27 federal budget on June 10, following coalition consultations. Emphasis is on fiscal sustainability, revenue enhancement via enforcement, and avoiding new taxes. Key stakeholders, including PPP leaders, are aligned on priorities, with no immediate renewables focus highlighted....

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Business Recorder

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Petition against IMF loan dismissed - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistani court dismisses a petition challenging IMF loan liability, citing lack of direct personal debt. No individual citizens are held liable per court records. No major renewables or financial results reported. Focus remains on legal clarification over IMF debt....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Hotter, drier summer in store as El Niño strengthens - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces a hotter, drier summer driven by El Niño, threatening agriculture and water supply. Northern regions see relief with above-normal rain, but risk flash floods. Enhanced reservoir levels may offset some impacts. High temps accelerate pest outbreaks and snowmelt, while extreme weather risks infrastructure damage....

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Business Recorder

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Naval chief for collective action against climate change - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s Naval Chief urges urgent global climate action, highlighting the nation’s high vulnerability to climate impacts. Emphasizing mangrove conservation, coastal cleanup, and public engagement, he calls for coordinated national and international efforts to boost resilience and sustainability amid rising extreme weather and environmental degradation....

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Business Recorder

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NTP 2025-30: Tariffs for various sectors to be gradually cut, PM told - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s National Tariff Policy 2025-30 aims to boost exports by reducing tariffs on logistics, construction, and pharmaceuticals. The government emphasizes tariff rationalization, tech-driven reforms, and sectoral support to drive economic growth, with the National Tariff Commission urged to modernize and facilitate investment....

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Business Recorder

Positive

IT & Telecom projects likely to get Rs20bn in budget FY2026-27 - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s 2026–27 budget allocates Rs20B for IT/telecom projects, including AI, cybersecurity, and IT parks, with heavy foreign assistance. Key initiatives focus on digital infrastructure, startups, and regional connectivity, reflecting a strategic push toward tech-driven economic growth and digital transformation....

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Business Recorder

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Economic governance crisis—II - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces deep governance and execution challenges, with fragmented institutions, weak FDI, and low human capital hindering economic transformation. Renewables and long-term strategy are critical, but without coherent governance, institutional continuity, and investment in human capital, sustainable energy and economic growth remain out of reach....

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Business Recorder

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Savings target set at 14.3pc of GDP - Business Recorder

Pakistan targets 4.0% GDP growth in FY26–27, with 14.3% savings and 15% investment, driven by reforms, remittances, and export recovery. Renewables and energy sectors see growth amid industrial revival. Job creation targets 2M, with public investment crowding out private, though external pressures loom....

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Business Recorder

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Stupendous funds, efforts required to meet climate commitments - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan aims to cut emissions by 50% by 2035, requiring USD565.7B in climate investment, with 33% reliant on international finance. A Danish-funded workshop trained journalists to improve climate reporting, emphasizing integration of climate policy across sectors and the need for evidence-based governance and media engagement to drive inclusive resilience....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Anthropic urges AI labs to pause development, warns humans risk losing control - Technology - Business Recorder

Anthropic urges AI labs to coordinate a pause amid fears of recursive self-improvement, citing rapid AI advancement and regulatory lag. Despite backlash and a U.S. security blacklist, it's raising \$965B and preparing for IPO, while pushing for global cooperation to manage AI risks—though rivals like OpenAI and xAI remain unresponsive....

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Business Recorder

Negative

New oil & gas discoveries boost Pakistan's energy reserves in 2025 - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan's hydrocarbon reserves rose 6% YoY in oil and 4% in gas, extending reserve life to 17 years (oil) and 18 years (gas), driven by key discoveries. This bolsters energy security amid geopolitical risks, particularly from the US-Iran conflict and reliance on Hormuz-linked imports. Renewables remain underdeveloped, but domestic exploration shows promise....

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Business Recorder

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IMF programmes' progress report: some reflections—II - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's economy faces persistent inflation and rising poverty, exacerbated by austerity policies and supply-side constraints. Despite IMF praise, recent data shows higher unemployment and rural poverty, undermining economic resilience. Renewables and green transition are sidelined amid neoliberal reforms, with calls for supply-side reforms, targeted support to farmers, and less austerity to stabilize prices and growth....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Solutions to meet Karachi's climate challenge elaborated - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Karachi faces escalating heatwaves due to climate change and urban degradation, urging green infrastructure investments. Leaders propose expanding riverine forests, mangrove conservation, and roadside tree plantations to combat heat, improve air quality, and enhance resilience—leveraging Karachi's natural assets for sustainable urban development....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Energy crisis shows need to speed up transition: climate envoys - World - Business Recorder

Middle East conflict and global heatwaves intensify pressure for urgent clean energy transition. COP31, hosted by Turkey with Australian leadership, underscores fossil fuel dependency as a driver of inflation and instability. Key voices call for accelerated renewables, electrification, and reduced fossil fuel reliance amid escalating energy crises....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Dar reviews auto policy for EV transition - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government, led by Deputy PM/FM Ishaq Dar, is accelerating EV adoption via a new Auto & Auto Parts Policy, aiming to boost manufacturing, jobs, exports, and climate goals. A stakeholder-led subcommittee will finalize the draft, signaling strong policy commitment to a sustainable, competitive automotive sector....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Federal Budget now likely to be announced on 12th - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal government may delay its 2026–27 budget presentation to June 12 due to finalizing key allocations. Higher funds allocated to Balochistan, Sindh, and KP; Punjab gets least. K-IV Water Project and Sukkur-Hyderabad Motorway slated for launch. Coalition negotiations on PSDP concluded....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Partly Facetious: The budget controversy - Opinion - Business Recorder

Government budget controversy centers on salary hikes for 7% of workforce, IMF approval, and frozen divisible pool. Development spending to be slashed despite budget rhetoric. Political maneuvering highlights coalition fragility and constitutional uncertainty. Renewables not mentioned....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Plea challenging capacity payment mechanism for IPPs dismissed - Pakistan - Business Recorder

LHC dismisses IPPs' constitutional challenge on capacity payments, affirming judicial restraint and separation of powers. Courts cannot review energy policy or tariff structures; such matters remain with regulators and policymakers. The ruling reinforces constitutional boundaries, rejecting claims based on policy disagreement alone....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Govt debt surges Rs1.4trn in April alone - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal government debt surged to Rs81.93 trillion in April 2026, driven by Rs882B in external borrowing and Rs523B in domestic debt. Fiscal pressures intensify as reliance on borrowing grows, with no significant renewables investment highlighted in this update....

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Business Recorder

Negative

Pak-China friendship reaches new heights: Tarar - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan reaffirms its commitment to CPEC and deepening China ties, citing strengthened bilateral cooperation, shared vision, and people-to-people bonds. Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's visit to China injected new momentum, while the government highlights cultural, media, and economic collaboration as key pillars of their "iron brother" partnership....

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Business Recorder

Positive

Nvidia launches Windows laptop chip in consumer PC push - World - DAWN.COM

Nvidia unveiled an AI-powered laptop chip for Windows, challenging Apple, Intel, and AMD. Targeting AI-driven consumer PCs, the move signals its push into consumer hardware amid record profits from data centers. Analysts see it as a strategic threat, aiming to dominate PC hardware and boost GPU demand through AI-centric computing....

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Dawn

Positive

Survey finds generational gap in attitudes to AI romance - World - DAWN.COM

AI companionship is gaining traction among young adults globally, with 48% believing AI will improve happiness, though adoption of AI dolls remains low (17%). Regional divides exist, with Asia more accepting than Western markets. Concerns over psychological impact and ethical implications persist, especially regarding vulnerable users....

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Dawn

Negative

BUDGET 2026-27: IMF-mandated curbs squeeze development spending - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's 2026 development plan totals Rs4.715tr, with Rs1.13tr allocated to PSDP—far below needs—triggering a "circular debt crisis." Infrastructure dominates spending, with energy, transport, and water prioritized. Provincial allocations rise, but federal constraints, IMF oversight, and debt burdens limit growth. Economic growth targeted at 4pc amid inflation of 8.2pc....

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Dawn

Negative

Parliamentary affairs minister says budget to be presented on June 10 - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

Pakistan delays FY2026-27 budget to June 10 amid coalition consultations, with IMF oversight. Growth target set at 4%, inflation at 8.2%. Fiscal cuts across sectors to fund highways, coalition shares, and party schemes. No new legislation planned; PPP remains a key ally....

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Dawn

Positive

Another meeting expected as PML-N, PPP continue budget discussions ahead of June 10 presentation - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's 2026-27 budget, to be tabled June 10, faces PPP pushback over taxation and IMF demands. Parties consult on fiscal sustainability, public welfare, and tax base expansion. Renewables and development spending are key priorities amid inflation concerns and IMF pressure....

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Dawn

Negative

Amazon unveils robotic AI warehouse in UK - World - DAWN.COM

Amazon invests \$11.6B in EU logistics, deploying AI robots like Proteus and STARK to enhance warehouse efficiency. New robots enable floor-level operation and conversational AI. Expansion of same-day delivery in Europe and US continues, with focus on robotics and automation to boost supply chain speed....

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Dawn

Positive

Gul Ahmed announces \$230m data centre - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's Quantum Global Data Centre, backed by Gul Ahmed Energy Group and Huawei, aims to become the country's largest Tier III facility by 2027, with \$230M initial investment. Leaders warn of rising AI compute demand and risk of costly imports if domestic infrastructure isn't scaled, highlighting digital transformation as critical for economic growth....

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Dawn

Positive

Why Houthis threatening Red Sea shipping could mean more for the oil market this time - World - DAWN.COM

Houthis threaten to ban Israeli-linked ships in Red Sea, escalating regional tensions. Iran's Hormuz closure disrupted Gulf exports; Saudi Arabia diverted 70% of crude to Yanbu. Houthis, aligned with Iran ideologically but not militarily, seek to pressure Israel/US, risking global energy flows. Renewables remain unaffected, but geopolitical risks heighten energy market volatility....

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Dawn

Negative

Pak-Iran border trade halt to trigger LPG shortages - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's Gabd-Rimdan border closure has disrupted LPG imports, causing shortages and soaring prices. Customs delays and security issues at other borders strain energy supply. Exports of perishables and energy goods are at risk, with officials urging urgent government intervention to restore trade and prevent nationwide energy and food crises....

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Dawn

Negative

BUDGET 2026-27: Budget timing in doubt after NEC meeting put off again - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Federal-provincial fiscal tensions escalate as Islamabad seeks Rs1T+ for strategic needs, sparking protests from provinces like KP, fearing deficits. Political deadlock, constitutional concerns, and IMF surplus commitments complicate consensus. KP urges urgent talks with Imran Khan, highlighting gas shortages, delayed infrastructure, and unequal resource distribution. Budget delays loom as technical and political hurdles persist....

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OECD predicts spate of recessions globally if Iran conflict drags into 2027

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UK urged not to further weaken EV rules as CO2 impact revealed

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‘Unpredictable and extreme’: Asia braces for El Niño

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The Guardian

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World’s first wind-powered underwater datacentre starts operating in China

China deploys the world’s first wind-powered underwater datacentre off Shanghai, reducing energy use by 20% and freshwater demand. Backed by government investment and AI strategy, this marks rapid commercialization of marine renewables. While promising, ecological impacts require monitoring....

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The Guardian

Positive

Federal Budget 2026-27 likely to be presented on June 12, says minister

Pakistan’s federal budget for FY2026-27 is delayed to June 12 amid coalition negotiations, with focus on fiscal consolidation, IMF coordination, and public welfare. Development spending exceeds Rs1.1 trillion. Renewables not highlighted; tax reforms and macroeconomic stability central to revised framework....

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@247pakistan معزز صارف، ہم سے رابطہ کرنے کا شکریہ...

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